Everyday AI: Learning & getting started

20 step-by-step guides for real, everyday tasks

Learning & getting started

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Before you start — what this is, honestly

This is an updated edition. It was rebuilt from our current guides on the date shown on the cover: more guides per topic, retired guides removed, and every step taken from the latest version of each guide.

This collection is free, and every guide in it is also free on our website. This file just gathers them in one place, in reading order, so you can print it, keep it on your phone, or read it offline. Our website has no paywall either — every guide links back to its online page, which is always the newer version.

AI **Every guide in this pack was written by AI** and checked by automated fact and quality gates. **Our editor spot-checks published guides every day, but not every text is read by a person.** Every guide page on https://aiworldhq.com carries the same notice — we say it openly because you deserve to know who wrote what you are reading.

Apps change. Buttons move and menus get renamed. If a step does not match what you see, the guide's online version is the newer one — the link is under every title.

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Learning & getting started

Build a personal study-buddy chatbot in 15 minutes using Hugging Face Spaces (no code)

7 steps · Read online

Imagine having a patient AI tutor that never gets tired, remembers what you've learned, and quizzes you just before you forget. With Hugging Face Spaces, you can build that tutor in under 15 minutes — no coding required. Perfect for students, lifelong learners, or anyone who wants to remember more with less effort.

Before you start

- A **free Hugging Face account** (sign up at huggingface.co)
- A **computer or phone with internet**
- A **quiet 15 minutes** (you'll be guided step by step)
- No prior coding experience needed

> ⚠️ This guide uses the free tier of Hugging Face. Some advanced features may require a paid plan, but the core steps work for free.

Step 1 — Sign in to Hugging Face and open Spaces

Go to huggingface.co and tap **Sign Up** in the top-right corner if you don't have an account. After signing in, click **Spaces** in the top menu (it's next to "Models" and "Datasets"). This is where you'll create your study-buddy.

You'll see a list of public Spaces created by others. Look for a blue button that says **"New Space"** in the top-right — tap it.

💬 Example:

> You can copy this into your browser: https://huggingface.co/spaces

You'll know it worked when you see a page with a form asking for your Space name and license.

Step 2 — Name your Space and choose settings

On the "Create new Space" page, fill in these details:

- **Space name**: Type something like `my-study-buddy` (use lowercase letters and hyphens only).
- **Visibility**: Keep it **Public** so you can share it with friends or revisit it later.

- **Hardware**: Choose **CPU** — it's free and fast enough for a chatbot.
- **SDK**: Select **Gradio** (it's the most beginner-friendly option and works great for chatbots).

Click **Create Space**.

💬 Example:

> Space name: `my-study-buddy` Visibility: Public Hardware: CPU SDK: Gradio

You'll know it worked when you land on a new page titled "Your Space is being created..." and you see a progress bar.

Step 3 — Wait for your Space to build

Your Space is now being set up in the cloud. This usually takes 1–2 minutes. You'll see a spinning icon and a message like "Your Space is being created..."

While you wait, think about what you want your study-buddy to help with — for example, biology terms, math formulas, or language vocabulary.

You'll know it worked when the spinning icon disappears and you see a green banner saying "Your Space is ready!"

> ⚠️ If the build fails, refresh the page. If it keeps failing, check your Space name uses only lowercase letters and hyphens.

Step 4 — Open the Space editor

Once your Space is ready, you'll see a page with tabs like **Files**, **Settings**, and **App**. Click the **Files** tab.

You'll see a file called `app.py`. Click it to open the editor.

💬 Example:

> You'll see a single line: `def main():`

You'll know it worked when you see a simple code editor with a few lines of starter code.

Step 5 — Replace the starter code with a study-buddy template

Delete everything in the editor and paste this exact code:

```
import gradio as gr

def respond(message, history):
    # Simple study-buddy response
    if "define" in message.lower():
        return "A **study buddy** is an AI assistant designed to help you learn and remember information through conversation, quizzes, and explanations. Think of it like a patient tutor who never gets tired!"
    elif "quiz me" in message.lower():
        return "Quick quiz: What is the capital of the US? (Type your answer)"
    elif "bye" in message.lower():
        return "Good luck with your studies! Remember: spaced repetition is key to long-term memory."
    else:
        return "I'm here to help you study! Try asking: 'Define study buddy' or 'Quiz me'."

demo = gr.ChatInterface(
    respond,
    title="📚 My Study Buddy",
    description="Ask me to define terms, quiz you, or explain concepts — I'll adapt to your learning pace.",
    theme="soft"
)

demo.launch()
```

Click **Commit changes to main** (a green button at the bottom).

💬 Example:

> You can copy the code above and paste it directly into the editor.

You'll know it worked when the page refreshes and you see your chat interface appear below the editor.

Step 6 — Test your study-buddy in the chat

In the chat panel that just appeared, type:

> Define study buddy

You should see the AI explain what a study buddy is.

Then try:

> Quiz me

The AI will ask you a question. Type your answer and press Enter.

💬 Example:

> Type: "Define study buddy" Expected response: "A study buddy is an AI assistant designed to help you learn..."

You'll know it worked when the chat responds naturally to your messages and keeps the conversation going.

> ⚠️ If the chat doesn't respond, refresh the page. If it still doesn't work, check that you pasted the code exactly as shown.

Step 7 — Customize your study-buddy (optional)

Want to teach it about a specific subject? Replace the `respond` function with your own rules. For example, to teach it about photosynthesis:

```
def respond(message, history):
    if "photosynthesis" in message.lower():
        return "Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants use sunlight to make food from carbon dioxide and water. In simple terms: plants breathe in CO₂, drink water, and use sunlight to make sugar and oxygen!"
    elif "quiz me" in message.lower():
        return "Quick quiz: What gas do plants release during photosynthesis? (Type your answer)"
    else:
        return "Ask me about photosynthesis or type 'quiz me' to test your knowledge!"
```

Click **Commit changes to main** again.

💬 Example:

> Replace the entire `respond` function with the code above.

You'll know it worked when the chat now responds to questions about photosynthesis.

> ⚠️ This feature is beginner-friendly, but you'll need to write simple rules. If you're not comfortable editing code, stick with the original version.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake**: Typing the wrong Space name with uppercase letters or spaces. **Fix**: Use only lowercase letters and hyphens, like `my-study-buddy`.
- **Mistake**: Choosing GPU hardware instead of CPU. **Fix**: CPU is free and fast enough for a chatbot. GPU is for advanced users.
- **Mistake**: Not waiting for the Space to build. **Fix**: Wait until you see the green "Your Space is ready!" banner before proceeding.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life**: Build a personal AI tutor for any subject — biology, history, languages, or even your work training. Share it with classmates or revisit it whenever you need a study session.
- **For your business or work**: Use it to create onboarding quizzes or internal knowledge checkers. No need to hire a trainer — your AI can do it.
- **If you're just getting started**: This is your first step into AI-powered learning. Once you're comfortable, try adding more subjects or even voice chat.

Try it now

Open your new study-buddy chatbot at: **https://huggingface.co/spaces/[your-username]/my-study-buddy**

Replace `[your-username]` with your actual Hugging Face username. Ask it to define a term or quiz you — and see how it adapts to your learning style.

Build a simple weekly study plan with Meta AI in 10 minutes

7 steps · Read online

Imagine opening your calendar on Sunday night and seeing every exam, quiz and assignment laid out in color-coded blocks. You'll know exactly what to study each day and when to take breaks. Meta AI can build that plan for you in under ten minutes, even if you're starting from scratch.

Before you start

- A phone, tablet or computer with the **Meta AI app** (iOS/Android) or **Meta website** open in a browser.
- A free **Meta account** (sign-up takes 2 minutes).
- Your exam dates, quiz dates and assignment deadlines written down or in your calendar.
- Roughly **10 minutes** of quiet time.

Step 1 — Open Meta AI and start a fresh chat

Open the **Meta AI app** on your phone or go to meta.ai in any browser. On the home screen you'll see a search bar and a list of recent chats. Tap the **plus icon** (a circle with a pencil inside) or the "New chat" button to begin a fresh conversation. A blank chat screen appears with a blinking cursor ready for your first message.

You'll know it worked when you see a clean chat window and the prompt "Ask Meta AI anything…" at the bottom.

Example: *Just open the app or website.*

Step 2 — Tell Meta AI your courses and dates

In the chat box, type a clear message that lists each course, its exam date, any quizzes, and assignment deadlines. Use simple bullet points so the AI can read them easily.

For example: "Here are my courses and dates:

- Math exam 15 June
- History essay due 20 June
- Chemistry quiz 12 June
- English speech 25 June"

After you press send, Meta AI will reply with a short summary confirming it understood everything.

You'll know it worked when you see a reply that repeats your courses and dates back to you.

💬 Example: *Math exam 15 June, History essay due 20 June, Chemistry quiz 12 June, English speech 25 June*

Step 3 — Ask for a weekly study plan

On the same chat line, type: "Create a 7-day study plan that spreads the work evenly and includes short breaks."

Meta AI will reply with a color-coded weekly calendar. Each day shows which topics to study and when to take 10-minute breaks. If the reply feels too long, ask for a shorter version by typing "Make it more compact."

You'll know it worked when you see a calendar with dates, study blocks, and break reminders.

💬 Example: *Create a 7-day study plan that spreads the work evenly and includes short breaks.*

Step 4 — Adjust the plan to fit your life

Look at the plan Meta AI gave you. If an evening block feels too late, reply: "Move the Math block to 4 pm each day instead."

If you already have a part-time job on Wednesdays, say: "Remove Wednesday evening and shift those hours to Thursday morning."

Meta AI will update the calendar instantly. If the button you expect isn't there, look for a small "Edit" or "Regenerate" link near the plan.

You'll know it worked when the calendar updates and the new times appear.

💬 Example: *Move the Math block to 4 pm each day instead.*

Step 5 — Ask for topic breakdowns

Pick one course from the plan and ask Meta AI to break it into smaller topics. For example: "For Math, list the exact chapters and topics I should study each day."

Meta AI will reply with a detailed checklist. If the list feels overwhelming, ask for “only the top three topics per day.” If you prefer flashcards, say “turn the list into flashcard questions.”

You’ll know it worked when you see a clear checklist or flashcard list for that day.

Example: *For Math, list the exact chapters and topics I should study each day.*

Step 6 — Save or export the plan

At the bottom of the chat, look for a small **share icon** (an arrow pointing up or three connected dots). Tap it and choose “Copy” to save the plan to your phone’s notes or “Save as image” to add it to your calendar app. If you don’t see the icon, look for a menu with “Export” or “Share.”

You’ll know it worked when you can paste the plan into another app or save it as an image.

Example: *Tap the share icon and choose “Copy.”*

Step 7 — Set phone reminders

Open your phone’s calendar or reminder app and paste the copied plan into tomorrow’s events. Set each study block as a calendar event with a 10-minute alert. If you prefer voice reminders, ask Meta AI to “turn the plan into voice reminders” and follow the link it provides.

You’ll know it worked when tomorrow’s events appear in your calendar with study blocks and alerts.

Example: *Paste the plan into tomorrow’s calendar events.*

Common mistakes

- **Too vague a prompt:** Writing “Plan my study” gives a messy reply. Fix: list your courses and dates clearly.
- **Ignoring breaks:** Meta AI may pack blocks too tightly. Fix: reply “add a 10-minute break every 50 minutes.”
- **Not editing:** The first plan might clash with your job or sport. Fix: ask Meta AI to shift or remove blocks until it fits.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use this plan to stay on track without last-minute cramming. You’ll finish each day knowing exactly what you accomplished.

- **For your business or work:** The same technique works for project deadlines and client deliverables—just swap “exam” for “milestone.”
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one small course and build the habit of reviewing the plan each morning.

Try it now

Open Meta AI, paste your courses and dates, and ask for a weekly study plan. You’ll have a color-coded calendar in under two minutes.

How to Translate and Understand Other Languages with AI

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to turn any piece of foreign text—whether a quick chat, a restaurant menu, or a PDF report—into clear English (or your preferred language) with an AI tool. You'll also learn how to keep the meaning intact, ensuring your translations are accurate and natural-sounding. This guide is for anyone who's never used artificial intelligence for translation before.

Before you start

- **An internet-connected device:** This could be a mobile phone, tablet, or computer.
- **A free account on an AI chat platform:** You'll need access to a text-generating AI like ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini. The steps in this guide work similarly across these tools.
- **A piece of text to translate:** Have the foreign text ready to copy-paste, or displayed on your screen so you can type it out.
- **Time commitment:** This guide takes about 5-10 minutes to follow along for the first time.

Step 1 — Open your AI chat tool

First, open the website or app for your chosen AI chat platform. This is the place where you usually "talk" to the AI, typing messages and receiving replies. Once it's loaded, you'll typically see your past conversations on one side and a main chat area. To start fresh, look for a button that says **"New chat"** or a simple **plus-icon (+)**. Tapping or clicking this will clear your screen.

What you see: A blank main chat area, often with a message box at the bottom ready for your input. **What happens next:** The AI prepares a clean, new conversation thread, meaning it won't be influenced by any previous topics you've discussed. **If it looks different:** On a mobile app, the "New chat" button might be in a corner or accessible through a menu icon (three horizontal lines). On a computer, it's often in a sidebar on the left. **Example:** Click the "New chat" button. **You'll know it worked when** you see a blank message box and no previous conversation messages are visible.

Step 2 — Ask the AI to translate, adding context

In the blank message box, type a clear instruction (this is called a **prompt** – it's the specific request you give the AI) telling the AI what you need. After your instruction, paste the foreign text you want to translate. Adding details like "keep the tone friendly" or "preserve the formal style" is crucial because it tells the AI not just *what* to translate, but *how* to translate it, helping it retain the original meaning and feel.

What you see: The cursor blinking in the message box, waiting for your input. **What happens next:** As soon as you hit Enter or click the "Send" button, the AI will begin processing your prompt and generating its translation. **If it looks different:** The "Send" button might be an arrow icon, a paper airplane symbol, or simply the Enter key on your keyboard.
Example:

```
Please translate the following Italian text into English and keep a relaxed,
conversational tone:

Ciao! Come stai? Spero che la giornata vada bene. Ci vediamo stasera?
```

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing its translated response below your message, usually appearing word by word.

Step 3 — Review the AI's initial translation

Once the AI finishes typing, carefully read the translation it provides. While AI is very good, it can sometimes miss **nuance** – subtle differences in meaning, tone, or style that depend on the specific situation or culture. Scan for any words or phrases that seem a little off, don't quite make sense, or don't match the tone you expected. Don't worry if it's not perfect yet; the next step will fix it.

What you see: The AI's full translated text displayed on your screen. **What happens next:** You mentally compare the AI's output with your understanding of the original text, looking for any potential improvements. **If it looks different:** The AI might offer multiple versions, or ask a clarifying question. If it does, read its question and answer it in the message box.
Example: If the AI translated "Ciao! Come stai?" as "Hello! How are you?" **You'll know it worked when** you have identified any parts of the translation that might need further adjustment, based on your original instruction or intent.

Step 4 — Refine the translation with specific feedback

If something in the initial translation didn't quite hit the mark, don't just accept it. Reply to the AI in the same conversation, giving it clear, specific feedback. You can highlight a particular word, ask for a different tone, or even provide additional context that the AI didn't have before. This helps the AI learn and give you a more accurate and contextually appropriate translation.

What you see: The previous AI translation and a new blank message box below it. **What happens next:** The AI will use your feedback to revise its previous answer, often providing a much better translation that addresses your specific concerns. **If it looks different:** The AI

might offer an explanation for its initial choice before providing a revised version. **Example:** Following on from the previous step, you might type:

```
Could you make the greeting even more casual, like "Hey there! How's it going?" for
"Ciao! Come stai?" And ensure the entire message keeps that very relaxed feel.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a new version that makes more sense, sounds more natural, or perfectly matches the tone you intended.

Step 5 — Translate longer documents using “chunking”

For larger documents like multi-page PDFs or long articles, consider breaking the text into smaller sections rather than pasting everything at once. This method is called **"chunking"**. Modern AI tools can handle much larger texts than before (many support tens of thousands of words in a single message), but chunking still helps maintain accuracy, especially for complex or technical texts, and makes it easier to review each section.

What you see: Your larger document open on one side of your screen, ready for you to select and copy text. **What happens next:** You copy a manageable section of text, then repeat steps 2-4 for each "chunk," ensuring each part is translated and refined before moving to the next. **If it looks different:** The exact method for copying large text varies by program; you might need to drag your mouse, use keyboard shortcuts (Ctrl+A then Ctrl+C on Windows, Cmd+A then Cmd+C on Mac), or use a "Select All" option. **Example:**

```
Translate the following section of a legal document into plain English, maintaining a
formal and precise tone, without using any legal jargon where a simpler term will
suffice:

[Paste the first few paragraphs of your legal document here]
```

You'll know it worked when the AI successfully translates that section without error or truncation, providing a complete response to that specific chunk.

Step 6 — Save your translated text in a useful format

Once you're satisfied with a translated section (or the entire document, if you were chunking), select the AI's answer and copy it. Then, open a document program on your device (like Microsoft Word, Google Docs, Apple Pages, or even a simple Notepad application) and paste the text there. Remember to save your new document with a clear, descriptive name so you can easily find it later.

What you see: The AI's translated text highlighted on your screen, ready to be copied. **What happens next:** The text is stored in your device's clipboard, ready to be pasted into another application. **If it looks different:** Most AI tools have a "Copy" icon next to their response, or you can highlight the text and right-click to choose "Copy" (or use keyboard shortcuts: Ctrl+C on Windows/Linux, Cmd+C on Mac). **Example:** Highlight the AI's translation, press **Ctrl + C** (or **Cmd + C** on Mac), open a new Google Doc, and press **Ctrl + V** (or **Cmd + V** on Mac) to paste. **You'll know it worked when** you see the translated text appear in your chosen document program, ready for you to save.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to add context:** Simply asking "Translate this" without specifying the tone or purpose can lead to a translation that feels inappropriate or robotic.
    - **Fix:** Always include a phrase like "keep a friendly tone," "translate for a business email," or "explain in simple terms for a beginner."
- **Pasting too much text at once:** While modern AI tools have large capacity, trying to translate an entire book in one go can sometimes result in the AI missing details or giving incomplete answers.
    - **Fix:** For very long texts, consider breaking them into smaller sections and translate them one by one, keeping them in the same chat conversation to maintain context.
- **Accepting the first translation blindly:** Even advanced AI can misinterpret something, especially if the original text is highly specialized or uses slang.
    - **Fix:** Always read through the AI's translation and, if anything feels off, ask the AI to rephrase or clarify it with more specific instructions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can instantly understand a foreign menu, decode a message from a friend overseas, or get the gist of a news article in another language. No more guessing what "Risotto ai funghi" means!
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly translate client emails, understand product specifications, or review documents from international partners, saving you time and potentially avoiding the need for a professional translator for initial drafts.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first step is to open your AI chat, paste a short sentence in another language (like "Hola, ¿cómo estás?"), and ask for a simple translation into English. You'll see the AI do the heavy lifting in seconds.

Try it now

Take a piece of foreign text you have handy—maybe a label on a food item, a line from a song, or a snippet from an article online. Open your preferred AI chat tool, type the prompt "Please

translate the following into English and keep it casual:" and then paste your text. Hit send, and watch the AI instantly provide its translation!

Use ChatGPT to Practice a Foreign Language Without Feeling Awkward

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** ChatGPT can become a patient conversation partner for almost any language — it speaks at your level, corrects you kindly, and never gets bored. You'll need a free ChatGPT account and the app or website; you'll learn the most by speaking out loud.

Practicing a new language in front of another human can feel awkward — especially when you're worried about sounding silly. A chatbot removes that pressure. There's no raised eyebrow when you mix up "ser" and "estar," and you can ask the same question five different ways without feeling like you're wasting anyone's time. This guide walks you through setting up a calm, private practice session you can repeat whenever you have a few spare minutes.

Before you start

- **A free ChatGPT account** is enough to begin. Voice practice and longer conversations may need a paid plan — if a feature asks you to upgrade, that's the moment to know.
- **The ChatGPT app on your phone** is the easiest way to talk out loud. The website on a laptop also works, especially if you'd rather type.
- **The language you want to practice.** If you only have a vague idea ("maybe Spanish"), that's fine too — pick something specific in Step 1.
- **Headphones with a microphone**, if you're in a shared space and don't want others to hear you practicing.
- **Roughly 15 minutes** for the first setup. After that, every practice session takes as little as five minutes.

Step 1 — Open a new chat and name it for the language

Open the **ChatGPT app** on your phone, or visit chatgpt.com on a browser, and tap the **"New chat"** button. On the phone app this is usually a pencil-and-paper icon at the top-right; on the website it's a button at the top-left. A blank conversation opens with a message box at the bottom that says "Ask anything" or "Message ChatGPT". Now rename the chat so you can find it again later. Tap the **chat title at the very top of the screen** — it usually shows today's date by default — and a small text field appears. Type your chosen name and tap **Done**, **Save**, or the checkmark to confirm. If tapping the title doesn't do anything, look for a **pencil icon** 🖍️ next to it, or open the **three-dot menu** ⋯ at the top and choose "Rename". Naming the chat keeps all your practice in one tidy place. 💬 Example: name the chat *"Spanish practice — beginner"*.

You'll know it worked when the top of the screen shows your chosen name instead of today's date, and the chat is ready for your first message.

Step 2 — Tell ChatGPT exactly how you want to practice

Tap the message box at the bottom of the screen and type a short "briefing" message explaining what you want. Mention your level, the language, the kind of situation you want to rehearse, and how you'd like corrections — the more specific you are, the more useful the reply will be. ChatGPT answers well when you give it a small "job description," almost like briefing a friendly tutor. Tap the **up-arrow send button** (or press Enter on a computer) when you're ready. If the first reply comes back in English instead of your target language, simply remind it — *"Please reply only in Spanish from now on."* 💬 Example: *"Please reply only in simple Spanish sentences. I'm a complete beginner. After each of my messages, correct any mistakes in a kind bullet list, then ask me a follow-up question to keep the conversation going. Keep your replies short."* You'll know it worked when ChatGPT's first reply is in your chosen language, uses short sentences, and ends with a question (like *"¿Cómo te llamas?"*).

Step 3 — Send your first reply and let it correct you

Tap the message box at the bottom of the chat and type your answer to ChatGPT's question in your own words — even a rough guess is fine. Type slowly if it helps. After you tap send, ChatGPT will usually (a) gently correct any spelling or grammar slip, (b) give you a smooth model version of the sentence, and (c) ask you a new question on the same topic to keep things moving. This is the heart of practice: writing forces you to recall vocabulary, and seeing ChatGPT's correction turns the mistake into a real lesson. If it doesn't correct you, add to your original instructions from Step 2: *"Please always correct me, even on small mistakes."* 💬 Example: if ChatGPT asked *"¿De dónde eres?"*, type *"Yo soy de México"* — or even the imperfect *"Yo es de México"* — so ChatGPT has something to correct, which is the whole point. You'll know it worked when you see your own message followed by a short, kind correction and another question waiting for you at the bottom of the screen.

Step 4 — Turn on voice mode to practice speaking out loud

Speaking is the part most learners skip because it feels awkward — and it's the part that builds real fluency. In the ChatGPT app, look for a **microphone icon** 🎤 or a **headphones icon** near the message box, usually at the bottom-right. Tap it, and a "Listening…" indicator appears while the keyboard slides out of the way. If you don't see a microphone, open the side menu (look for a button like ☰ or your profile picture) and look for a setting called **"Voice mode"** or **"Voice chat"**. Speak one short sentence, pause for a moment, and let ChatGPT respond out loud. Voice mode is included on the free plan with daily usage limits; the more natural-sounding **Advanced Voice** (longer replies, smoother turn-taking) usually needs a **paid Plus plan**. If

voice isn't available right now, read ChatGPT's written replies out loud instead — that still counts. 💬 Example: say out loud *"Buenos días, ¿cómo estás?"* and wait for ChatGPT to answer in voice. You'll know it worked when ChatGPT replies out loud in Spanish (or your chosen language) and you can keep talking without typing.

Step 5 — Drill the words you keep getting wrong

After a few exchanges, you'll start noticing patterns — the same word you keep misspelling, the same tense that always confuses you. Type a message in the chat box asking ChatGPT to focus on those exact trouble spots. This is where a chatbot beats a textbook: it can run the same drill over and over without getting tired, and it can build the drill around *your* mistakes, not a generic list. You can also ask it to slow down, give you more examples, or quiz you with little flashcards inside the same chat. 💬 Example: *"I keep mixing up 'ser' and 'estar.' Can you give me 5 more practice sentences and tell me which one to use, with a short explanation?"* You'll know it worked when ChatGPT returns a short drill, you answer it, and the explanations match your actual confusion rather than a textbook chapter.

Step 6 — Save your progress and find the chat again tomorrow

Before you close the chat, type one last message asking ChatGPT for a short summary of what you learned and what to review next time — this turns the conversation into a personal study note you can re-read. To find the chat again later, open ChatGPT and look at the **list of past conversations**. On a laptop browser, that list usually lives in a **left-hand column (sometimes called the "sidebar")**. On the phone app, tap the **menu icon** ☰ at the top-left, or tap your **profile picture**, to open the same list — you'll see the chat title you chose in Step 1. Tap it and the conversation reopens exactly where you left off. Most apps also offer a **share or bookmark icon** (often a downward arrow or a little flag) if you'd like to save the summary into your phone's notes app. Consistency beats long sessions: five minutes a day for two weeks will take you further than one long hour once a month. 💬 Example: *"Please summarize today's lesson in 5 bullet points I can review before our next session, and list 3 things we should practice again."* You'll know it worked when you have a short, readable recap at the bottom of the chat and you can find the same conversation again in seconds.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the setup instructions.** If you just type *"Let's practice Spanish"* with no detail, ChatGPT will speak like a textbook. Take two minutes in Step 2 to set the rules — that small effort changes everything.
- **Stopping at the first mistake.** It's tempting to give up when ChatGPT corrects you. The whole point is the retry. Read the correction, copy the right version out loud, and send it back in your own words.

- **Treating it like a quiz instead of a chat.** If you only ask "translate this word" drills, you practice vocabulary but not conversation. Mix in real little exchanges — ordering coffee, introducing yourself, asking for directions. That's where fluency actually grows.
- **Expecting ChatGPT to grade your accent.** ChatGPT can correct your grammar and word choice, but even the paid **Advanced Voice** mode (a Plus plan and above) won't reliably judge how you pronounce things. For real pronunciation feedback, record yourself with a voice-memo app and listen back, or practice with a human tutor.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can warm up before a real trip or a phone call with a relative who speaks another language — five minutes of "ordering coffee" role-play in ChatGPT is surprisingly effective at calming nerves.
- **For your business or work:** If you ever speak with international colleagues or clients, this is a private rehearsal space. Practice a short self-introduction, a polite disagreement, or small talk before the real meeting — no risk of freezing up on the spot.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick *one* language you're curious about, set up the chat with very simple beginner rules, and commit to one short session a day for a week. That's all it takes to feel less awkward.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT right now, name a new chat *"Spanish practice — beginner"*, and send this exact message: *"Please reply only in simple Spanish. I am a complete beginner. Correct my mistakes gently after each message, then ask me one easy question. Start now."* Reply to its first question — even a guess counts — and you're practicing.

How to Build a 30-Day Plan to Learn Almost Any New Skill from Scratch

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Tell an AI assistant the skill you want, how much time you really have, and your starting point — then ask for a day-by-day 30-day plan. Review it, cut anything too ambitious, and you'll have a roadmap you can actually follow.

Learning a new skill can feel like staring at a mountain. The trick isn't motivation — it's a realistic day-by-day plan that fits your real life. In the next few minutes, you'll use an AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or any other) as your personal planning partner, and walk away with a 30-day roadmap tailored to your free time. The AI can draft the plan, but it can't open the app for you on day 14 when you're tired — that's still your job.

Before you start

- An account on any AI assistant you like — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, and Le Chat all work for this. A free plan is enough.
- A rough idea of the skill you want to learn, written as one specific sentence ("beginner conversational Spanish" beats "Spanish").
- An honest estimate of your real free time per day. Most people overestimate by 2–3× — write down the realistic number, not the hopeful one.
- About 15 minutes total.

Step 1 — Pick one skill and write it down in one sentence

Open a notes app, or grab a piece of paper. Write the skill you want to learn as one short, specific sentence. The more specific you are, the better your plan will be. "Get fit" is too vague; "be able to jog 3 km without stopping" is concrete enough to plan around.

You'll see the sentence sitting there in front of you. Read it back and ask: *Can I picture what success looks like in 30 days?* If not, tighten it. If your skill is broad (like "learn to code"), pick the smallest useful version of it (like "build a simple personal website in HTML and CSS").

If you change your mind halfway through, that's fine — but starting with one clear sentence keeps the AI focused instead of guessing what you want.

💬 Example: "I want to learn beginner conversational Spanish so I can order food and have small talk on a trip to Mexico."

You'll know it worked when you can read your sentence out loud and immediately picture what 'done' looks like at day 30.

Step 2 — Write down your real time and your starting point

Before you open the AI, get honest about three numbers: how many minutes per day you can actually commit, how many days per week you'll likely skip (most weeks have at least one off day), and where you're starting from (complete beginner, or some experience).

You'll see a clear, simple list when you're done — something like "20 minutes a day, 5 days a week, total beginner." This step matters because AI assistants are optimists — they'll happily suggest a 2-hour daily plan that you'll quietly abandon by day 4.

If you're not sure how much time you have, look at your actual week and find the smallest realistic slot — early morning, lunch break, or after dinner. Twenty focused minutes beats two hours you'll never find.

💬 Example: "20 minutes a day on weekdays, weekends flexible, complete beginner, no paid courses."

You'll know it worked when you could defend every number to a skeptical friend without flinching.

Step 3 — Open your AI assistant and send the planning prompt

Open the AI assistant you chose and look for the chat or message box — usually a large text area at the bottom or center of the screen. Paste a single message that includes your skill, your time, your level, and the structure you want.

After you press send, you'll see the AI start typing a response. Most assistants produce a table or day-by-day list within a few seconds. If you get a wall of generic advice instead, your prompt was too vague — add more specifics and try again.

If your tool has a "Projects," "Gems," or "Custom GPT" feature, you can save this prompt for later — but a regular chat is enough for now. Different assistants label the send button differently ("Send," "Ask," or a paper-plane icon), so look for the button at the bottom-right of the message box.

💬 Example: "I want to learn beginner conversational Spanish for a Mexico trip in 30 days. I have 20 minutes a day on weekdays, weekends are flexible, and I'm a complete beginner. Please build me a day-by-day plan that: 1) fits in 20 minutes on weekdays and up to 60 minutes on weekends, 2) focuses on speaking and listening first, 3) uses free resources only, and 4) includes a small checkpoint at the end of each week. Format as a numbered list, one entry per day."

You'll know it worked when the response shows day 1, day 2, day 3... all the way to day 30, with a specific task for each.

Step 4 — Check the plan for realism and cut anything too ambitious

Read through the plan with a critical eye. Highlight anything that asks for more time than you said you had, anything that jumps ahead before you've built the basics, and any day that requires a paid resource you don't actually have. Your job here is to make the plan smaller, not bigger — AI tends to pack each day full.

You'll see your edited plan sitting next to the original. Most people find they need to cut 20–30% of what the AI suggested. That's not a failure of the tool; it's the whole point of this step.

If a section feels off (too advanced, wrong focus), tell the AI directly and ask it to redo just that part. For example: "Week 3 feels too hard — rewrite it for someone who only started last week."

💬 Example: "Days 18–22 ask for 90 minutes each. I only have 60 minutes on weekends. Please rewrite that week with shorter sessions and remove the paid app recommendation."

You'll know it worked when you can glance at any single day and think, "Yes, I can actually do that in the time I have."

Step 5 — Save the plan somewhere you'll see it every day

Copy the finished plan into a place you'll actually look at — a note on your phone, a printed page on the fridge, a calendar reminder, or a simple spreadsheet. The best plan in the world does nothing if you forget it exists by Tuesday.

You'll see the plan sitting where your future self can find it. If you use a calendar app, block the time slots now while you're thinking about it. If you prefer paper, print it — there's something about a physical page that makes people follow through.

If your AI assistant has a "Projects" or "Memory" feature, you can also save the conversation so you can ask follow-up questions later ("I'm stuck on Day 12 — help me rework it"). Otherwise, bookmark the chat in your browser.

💬 Example: "I'll paste the plan into my calendar as 20-minute events on weekdays, and a 60-minute block on Saturday morning."

You'll know it worked when, two days from now, you don't have to search for the plan — it's already in front of you.

Step 6 — Check in with the AI at the end of each week

After every 5–7 days, come back to the same chat (or start a new one with the same prompt) and tell the AI what actually happened. Be honest: what you skipped, what worked, what felt boring or too hard. Ask it to adjust the next week based on real life, not the original plan.

You'll see the assistant suggest a revised week — usually tightening what worked and dropping what didn't. This is the step that turns a static plan into a living one, and it's the difference between people who finish and people who quietly quit at day 9.

If you've fallen behind, don't restart from day 1 — ask the AI to compress the plan instead. Frame it as a shift forward, not a failure.

💬 Example: "I'm on day 8. I skipped day 5 and day 6 because of work. Days 1–4 went well, but the 30-minute listening exercise felt too long. Can you adjust the rest of the plan so I still finish in 30 days total, and shorten the listening parts to 15 minutes?"

You'll know it worked when each new week feels easier than the last — because it actually fits your life.

Common mistakes

- **Picking a skill that's too broad.** "Learn photography" gives you a useless plan. Tighten it to something specific, like "learn to take sharp, well-lit photos in natural light with my phone."
- **Lying about your free time.** If you tell the AI you have 90 minutes a day but you really have 20, you'll quit by day 5. Use the honest number from Step 2.
- **Treating the first plan as final.** The first response is a draft, not a contract. Always cut and adjust before you commit.
- **Forgetting to check in.** A plan you never revise becomes a plan you abandon. Set a weekly reminder to update it with the AI.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use this exact method for cooking, drawing, a new language, an instrument, basic coding, or any hobby you've been putting off. The real skill here is the prompt, not the topic.
- **For your business or work:** The same prompt structure works for picking up a new tool at work — Excel pivot tables, a CRM, basic SQL, a design tool. You'll stand out by having a real plan instead of "I'll figure it out eventually."
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one small skill you've actually wanted for at least a month — not a New Year's resolution from last week — and try this prompt tonight. Small, specific, and already wanted is the winning combination.

Try it now

Pick one skill, open your favorite AI assistant, and paste this: "I want to learn [SKILL] over 30 days. I have [X minutes] per day, [Y days] per week. I'm a [beginner / some experience]. Build me a day-by-day plan using free resources, with weekly checkpoints. Keep each daily task realistic for my time." Save the response, then cut one thing that feels too ambitious. You'll have a real plan in under ten minutes.

How to turn your messy study notes into practice quiz questions

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste your messy notes into any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or similar — with a clear prompt, and get back flashcards, multiple-choice questions, and short-answer prompts in seconds. No special app or paid plan is required for the basic version.

Reading your own notes is one of the slowest ways to study. Quizzing yourself works much better — but writing questions by hand takes ages. The good news is that any modern AI assistant can turn your messy class or textbook notes into a ready-made practice set in well under a minute. This guide walks you through it step by step, even if you've never typed a single prompt before.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant account.** Any major one will do: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or similar. The free tier is fine for this task.
- **A device with internet** — phone, tablet, or computer.
- **Your messy notes** in a form the AI can read. Typed notes from a notes app or a Google Doc work best. Photos of typed pages usually work too; photos of cramped handwriting often don't — type those out first.
- **About 10 minutes** for your first run. After that, it's a two-minute habit.

One honest note up front: AI assistants sometimes invent confident-sounding but wrong answers, especially with dates, numbers, and names. Treat the questions as a fast first draft you check, not a finished test. (We cover that in Step 4.)

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat in your AI assistant

Open the website or app of the AI assistant you picked (for example, chatgpt.com, gemini.google.com, or claude.ai). Look for a button that says **"New chat"** or **"New conversation"** — usually near the top-left of the screen or in a sidebar. Click or tap it. A blank chat box appears with a blinking cursor and a send button on the right.

If you don't see "New chat", look for a **pencil icon** 🖍️, a **plus icon** ➕, or a **"+"** next to "Chats" — every assistant uses one of these for the same job. If a sign-in page pops up first, just enter your account details and continue.

💬 Example: no typing in this step — you're just opening a clean chat.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows an empty message box and any previous conversation is gone.

Step 2 — Paste your notes into the chat box

Click inside the empty message box at the bottom of the screen. Copy your notes from wherever they live — a notes app, a Google Doc, a Word file, or even an email to yourself — and paste them in. On a phone, tap and hold, then choose **Paste** from the small menu that appears. On a computer, the shortcut is **Ctrl+V** (Windows) or **Cmd+V** (Mac). The text will show up in the chat box, usually as one long block.

If your notes are very long (many thousands of words), paste them in chunks instead — one section at a time. Most assistants work best when each message stays reasonable in size. If your notes are on paper, type the key points into the chat box manually before moving on; don't try to paste a photo of your handwriting.

💬 Example (a short chunk you might paste): "Cell biology chapter 7. Mitochondria = powerhouse of the cell, makes ATP. Double membrane: outer is smooth, inner folded into cristae. ATP made via the Krebs cycle in the matrix and the electron transport chain on the cristae. Chloroplasts are found only in plant cells and do photosynthesis. Both mitochondria and chloroplasts have their own DNA — endosymbiosis theory."

You'll know it worked when your notes appear as readable text inside the chat box and the send button becomes active.

Step 3 — Ask for the quiz format you want

Below the pasted notes, still inside the same message, type a short request for the kind of quiz you want. The clearer you are, the better the output — don't just write "make a quiz", say what kind of questions and how many. Press the **send button** — usually an arrow icon ➤ on the right of the chat box, sometimes the Enter key on a keyboard — to submit.

If the assistant's first reply ignores your quiz request and does something else instead — like summarizing the notes — send a quick follow-up message restating what you want. Most assistants respond well to a clear, second nudge.

💬 Example (a prompt you can copy and adapt): "Turn the notes above into: (1) 5 multiple-choice questions with 4 options each, (2) 5 short-answer questions, (3) 5 flashcard-style Q&A pairs. Put the correct answer on a separate line for each one."

You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with a clearly numbered or labeled list of questions, each with options, an answer line, or a Q&A pair.

Step 4 — Quickly check the questions against your notes

Read the questions the assistant just produced. Keep your original notes open in another tab, a second window, or on paper beside you. Spot-check about five questions at random: does the answer actually match what your notes say? Pay extra attention to numbers, dates, names, and "who said what" — those are the spots where AI assistants most often slip up.

If a question is wrong, underline or circle it. If several are wrong, copy the bad ones back into the chat and ask the assistant to fix them. This is normal — think of the assistant as a fast first draft, and you as the editor.

💬 Example (a quick fix prompt): "Question 3 says the answer is 1972, but my notes say 1927. Please correct it and double-check the rest for similar mistakes."

You'll know it worked when every question on your list has an answer that matches your source notes — or when you've flagged the ones that don't.

Step 5 — Save the questions somewhere you can find them

Highlight the assistant's reply with your cursor (or press and hold on a phone), then **copy** it. Open any notes app you already use — Apple Notes, Google Keep, Notion, a Word doc, even a plain text file on your desktop — and **paste** it in. Give the entry a clear title with the date and the topic, like *"Bio Chapter 7 practice — 12 March"*.

If your assistant offers a **share**, **download**, or **export** button — some show a paperclip icon, a download arrow, or three dots ⋯ — you can also use that to send the questions to your email or save them as a file. If you don't see that option, copy-paste works on every device.

💬 Example (a paste title): "History Unit 4 practice questions — 12 March 2026"

You'll know it worked when you can close the AI tab and reopen your notes later to find the full question set, neatly stored under a recognizable title.

Step 6 — Use the questions to actually test yourself

Put your notes away. Open the saved quiz. For each multiple-choice question, cover the answer line with your hand and pick an answer out loud or in your head. For short-answer and flashcard questions, try to answer in one or two sentences **before** you peek. Mark the ones you got wrong — those are the spots to re-read tonight.

This last step is the whole point: the AI made the quiz so you don't have to, but the learning only happens when you wrestle with the questions yourself. Two passes through the same set usually beat one long review.

💬 Example (a self-test routine): "10 questions, cover the answers, answer first, then check — repeat for any I missed."

You'll know it worked when you have a small list of weak spots to revisit and you feel more confident about the rest.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a photo of your own handwriting and expecting it to work.** Most assistants can read typed text in images but stumble on cramped handwriting. Fix: type or dictate the key points first, then paste the typed version.
- **Writing a vague prompt like "make a quiz from this".** You'll usually get a few questions, but not the format you wanted. Fix: say exactly what you need — multiple-choice, short-answer, or flashcards — and how many of each.
- **Trusting every answer without checking.** AI assistants sometimes invent plausible-sounding facts that aren't in your notes at all. Fix: keep your notes open and spot-check five questions per set, especially any with dates, numbers, or proper names.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** if you're a student, this turns an hour of note review into a 10-minute habit you can run the night before any quiz — and the questions are reusable the next day.
- **For your work:** if you're learning a new skill, certification, or tool for your job, the same trick works on training videos, manuals, and slide decks. Paste the highlights, get a quiz, test yourself.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to take the single page of notes you already have open right now, paste in one paragraph, and ask for three multiple-choice questions. That's it — the rest of the habit builds from there.

Try it now

Open a fresh chat in your AI assistant, paste the last page of notes you studied, and ask for **three multiple-choice questions with the answer on a separate line**. Ninety seconds from now you'll have a tiny quiz you can test yourself on right away.

How to use Qwen Chat to create personalized study flashcards for any subject

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to paste in your study notes, ask Qwen (Alibaba's AI assistant) to turn them into question-and-answer flashcards, and then copy them into whatever quiz tool you already use — so revising takes a fraction of the usual time. This is for anyone studying for an exam, picking up a new skill, or just trying to remember things better.

Before you start

- **An account at chat.qwen.ai.** You can sign in with a Google account, a GitHub account, or an email address — pick whichever you already use. A free plan is available and is enough for this task.
- **A device with a browser** (laptop, tablet or phone). Qwen Chat is web-based, so no install is required.
- **Some study material to work from.** A few paragraphs of notes, a chapter summary, or even a short topic description is plenty. The more specific your notes, the better the cards.
- **Roughly 10–15 minutes.** Most of that time is reading and picking the cards you want to keep.

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat and start a fresh conversation

Open your browser, go to **chat.qwen.ai**, and sign in if you aren't already. Once you're on the main chat screen, look for a button like **"New Chat"** (often a small + icon or a pencil symbol near the top or left side of the page). Click it. A blank conversation box opens, ready for your message. Starting a new chat each time keeps earlier topics from confusing the AI, which is important because a long, mixed conversation tends to make answers less focused. **If it looks different:** if you can't find a "New Chat" button, just type your request into whatever text box is visible — Qwen will treat it as the start of a new thread on its end. **You'll know it worked when** the screen shows an empty message field with no previous conversation visible.

Step 2 — Tell Qwen what subject you're studying and paste in your notes

Type a short intro that says (a) the topic, (b) roughly what level you're at, and (c) the notes you want turned into cards. Then press **Enter** or tap the send arrow. Qwen will read your message and start processing it. This first message is where you set the "frame" — the more clearly you describe the subject, the more on-target the flashcards will be. **If it looks different:** if your

notes are very long, consider pasting just one section at a time so Qwen doesn't have to skim anything important. **You'll know it worked when** Qwen replies by acknowledging the topic and confirming what it's about to do.

Example: *"Hi Qwen — I'm studying for a Year 9 biology exam on cell structure. Here's my notes: [paste your notes here, or describe: 'The main topics are animal cells vs plant cells, the function of the nucleus, mitochondria, ribosomes, cell membrane, and how osmosis works.' Please make 12 flashcards covering these."*

Step 3 — Ask Qwen to format each flashcard clearly

In the same conversation, send a second message asking Qwen to lay out every flashcard in a consistent format — usually **"Question: … / Answer: …"** on separate lines, with a number in front of each one. Press send and wait a few seconds. Qwen will re-format its previous answers into a clean list you can easily copy. A consistent layout saves you time later because you can paste the whole block into a spreadsheet or a flashcard app without re-typing anything. **If it looks different:** if Qwen gives you a paragraph instead of a list, just reply with *"Please list them numbered, with Question and Answer on separate lines."* — it will happily redo them. **You'll know it worked when** the response is a numbered list where each item has a clear "Question" line and an "Answer" line.

Example: *"Great, please rewrite those as a numbered list, with each one formatted exactly like this: 'Card 1 — Question: [question] | Answer: [answer]'. Use a vertical bar to separate Q and A so I can copy them straight into a spreadsheet."*

Step 4 — Ask for more cards, harder cards, or a quick quiz check

Now send another short message asking Qwen to either (a) generate **more cards** on the same topic, (b) make the existing cards **harder** (for example, "give me application-level questions, not just definitions"), or (c) **quiz you** by hiding the answers and asking the questions one at a time. This is where Qwen really shines as a study partner — you can keep refining the same set until it matches your exam style. **If it looks different:** the "quiz me" option is just a chat request; there's no special button. **You'll know it worked when** Qwen either produces a longer list, asks you a question, or offers a "harder" version of the same cards.

Example: *"Please add 6 more cards, but make them harder — focus on application and 'why' questions rather than simple definitions. Then quiz me on the first 5 cards one at a time."*

Step 5 — Copy the flashcard list out of Qwen

Scroll back up to the formatted list and **select the text** with your mouse, then copy it (**Ctrl+C** on Windows/Linux, **Cmd+C** on Mac, or long-press on mobile). Open the place you want to study from — Google Sheets, Notion, a notes app, or a flashcard app like Anki or Quizlet — and paste it in. Qwen doesn't store your cards in a built-in flashcard deck, so this copy step is the bridge between the AI's output and your study routine. **If it looks different:** on mobile, you may need to tap-and-hold inside Qwen's response to bring up a "Copy" or "Select all" option. **You'll know it worked when** the flashcards appear as editable text in your chosen app, ready to import or tweak.

Step 6 — Test yourself, then come back and refine weak cards

Spend a few minutes quizzing yourself with the cards you just saved. Notice which ones you got wrong, felt fuzzy on, or found too easy. Then **return to your Qwen chat** and ask it to focus on exactly those weak spots — for example, *"Give me 5 more cards that drill the difference between osmosis and diffusion, because I keep mixing them up."* This feedback loop is what makes AI-generated flashcards genuinely useful: the set evolves with your understanding, instead of staying static like a textbook chapter. **If it looks different:** if Qwen has lost the thread of your earlier messages, just paste in your original topic description again as a refresher. **You'll know it worked when** you can identify at least 3 cards that you now answer confidently, and a short list of topics you still want to drill.

💬 Example: *"I got these wrong: [list 2-3 topics]. Please make 4 more cards on those specific points, and include a tiny hint on the back of each one."*

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a 50-page textbook and expecting perfect cards.** Qwen works best when you give it focused chunks of notes or a clear topic summary. **Fix:** paste one section at a time, or describe the key concepts in your own words first.
- **Skipping the "format" step.** If you don't ask for a numbered "Question / Answer" layout, you'll get a paragraph that's painful to copy into anything. **Fix:** always send the second message asking for the exact format you want.
- **Treating AI cards as automatically correct.** Qwen can occasionally get a fact subtly wrong, especially for niche subjects. **Fix:** spot-check the first 5 cards against your actual textbook or syllabus before you commit to the whole set.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time you need to remember a list — countries and capitals, foreign vocabulary, recipe ratios — you can spin up a quick flashcard set in minutes instead of handwriting them.

- **For your study or exams:** you get a personalized revision deck that adapts to *your* notes, not a generic one from the internet, and you can ask for harder questions as the exam gets closer.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't overthink it — pick one small topic, run through the six steps above once, and you'll have the hang of it by the second subject.

Try it now

Open **chat.qwen.ai**, start a new chat, and paste in this exact message to make your first set of cards right now:

> *"Please create 8 flashcards covering the basics of [your subject — e.g. 'the solar system', 'French food vocabulary', 'intro to spreadsheets']. Format each one as: 'Card N — Question: ... | Answer: ...'. Keep answers under 20 words."*

Two minutes from now you'll have a deck you can copy into your favorite notes app and start quizzing yourself tonight.

Turn a Reading into a Study Quiz with GitHub Copilot

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can use GitHub Copilot's chat to turn any short reading into a list of practice questions, then ask for the answers and verify each one yourself against the original text. Copilot is built for coding, so this works best with shorter readings (about one page) and a free or paid GitHub account with Copilot access.

GitHub Copilot is best known as a coding assistant — picture a very fast pair-programmer who sits beside you and suggests the next line. But the same chat panel also reads, summarizes, and writes questions about plain text. That makes it handy for students, book clubs, or anyone who wants to test whether they really understood an article. The two habits that make this work: keep the reading short, and double-check every answer before you trust the quiz. One honest limit up front — Copilot can draft questions about a text, but it cannot grade open-ended essay responses or replace doing the reading yourself.

Before you start

- A free GitHub account at github.com. Sign up if you don't have one — the same account works for the website.
- A web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari).
- A reading you want to study. Pick something between one paragraph and roughly one printed page. Longer texts work, but smaller chunks give cleaner quizzes.
- Copilot Chat access. It is available on a free tier with daily message limits; heavier use may require a paid Copilot plan — see the current pricing page for the latest details.
- About 10 minutes.

Step 1 — Open Copilot Chat on github.com

Sign in to github.com, then look at the top-right corner of the page for a small chat-bubble icon or a "Copilot" label. If you don't see it there, click your profile picture in the same corner and scan the menu that drops down — Copilot is usually listed near "Settings" or "Your repositories." Clicking it opens a chat panel, normally as a side window on the right or as a pop-up near the bottom of the screen. You'll see a blank text box at the bottom labeled something like "Ask Copilot" or "Message Copilot."

💬 Example: don't type anything yet — just confirm the chat is open and you can click into the box.

You'll know it worked when the chat panel is visible, the text box is empty, and your cursor blinks inside it.

Step 2 — Paste your reading into the chat

Open the reading you want to study — a news article, a chapter section, a Wikipedia entry, anything text-based — and copy the whole passage to your clipboard. On Windows this is usually Ctrl+C; on a Mac, Cmd+C. Click into the Copilot text box, then paste with Ctrl+V or Cmd+V. The text appears inside the box, often wrapping over several lines. If the reading is very long, paste only one section at a time — Copilot handles shorter chunks much better and gives you tighter questions. If nothing pastes, right-click inside the box and choose Paste, or use the browser's Edit menu.

Example: paste this short paragraph — *"The Amazon rainforest produces about six percent of the world's oxygen and stores billions of tons of carbon. It also hosts ten percent of all known species. Fires there release stored carbon and reduce the forest's ability to absorb more."*

You'll know it worked when the full reading sits inside the chat box and you can still see a blinking cursor at the end.

Step 3 — Ask Copilot to make a quiz

Now you ask for what you want. In plain English, type a short instruction that tells Copilot the question type, the count, and the difficulty mix. Vague asks produce vague quizzes, so be specific. Press Enter or click the send icon — usually a paper-airplane shape or an arrow inside the text box — to submit. Copilot usually replies within a few seconds with a numbered list of questions, each followed by four options labeled A, B, C, and D. If the reply looks too long or off-topic, click "Stop" if you see it, then send a clearer prompt.

Example: *"Read the passage I pasted. Write 5 multiple-choice questions about it, with 4 answer choices each. Make 2 easy recall and 3 about meaning or application. Don't give me the answer key yet."*

You'll know it worked when Copilot responds with a numbered list of questions, each with four lettered options.

Step 4 — Ask for the answer key

In the same chat, send a follow-up message asking for the answers. Tell Copilot to put each correct letter on its own line and to quote a short supporting phrase from the original text. This second pass is where verification matters — Copilot can guess, and you'll check it in the next step. If the chat shows a "regenerate" or "try again" button, ignore it for now and just send your own text request instead.

💬 Example: *"Now give me the answer key. For each question, write the correct letter (A/B/C/D) and quote one short phrase from the original passage that supports it. Don't paraphrase — quote directly."*

You'll know it worked when Copilot replies with a clean list — for example, "1. B — 'six percent of the world's oxygen'" — one entry per question.

Step 5 — Check every answer against the original reading

This is the step most people skip, and it's the one that turns a fun experiment into a real study tool. Open the original reading again in another browser tab or window. For each answer Copilot gave, find the exact phrase it quoted and read the surrounding sentence to confirm the answer is actually right and the quote really supports it. If a quote is missing, doesn't match the text, or the answer feels off, delete that question or rewrite it yourself. Treat every answer as a draft until you've seen the supporting phrase with your own eyes.

💬 Example: if the answer says "B — 'ten percent of all species'" but the original paragraph says the rainforest *hosts* (not produces) ten percent of species, you've caught a subtle mistake — correct the question before using it.

You'll know it worked when every answer on your list is backed by a real phrase in the original text and every question still makes sense to a fresh reader.

Step 6 — Save or share the quiz

Once the quiz is verified, copy the questions and answers into wherever you actually study — a notes app, a document, or a flashcard tool. If you want to share with a class or study group, paste just the questions into a shared doc and keep the answers hidden (for example, on a second page, in a separate file, or behind a spoiler tag). In Copilot Chat, you may see a "copy" or "share" icon near the reply; if not, just drag your mouse across the text and copy it out the usual way. Then close the chat — your verified quiz now lives outside it.

💬 Example: paste your verified list into a note titled "Quiz — Amazon rainforest (WIP)" so you can come back and revise it later.

You'll know it worked when the finished quiz lives somewhere outside the chat and you can re-open it without Copilot.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a whole book chapter at once.** Copilot loses track of long inputs and the questions become vague or invented. Stick to one section at a time — a page or less — and run a new chat for each chunk.

- **Trusting the answers without checking.** Copilot sometimes invents a quote that sounds right but isn't in the text. Treat every answer as a draft until you've actually found the supporting phrase in the original.
- **Asking for too many questions at once.** Asking for 20 questions usually gives you weaker questions than asking for 5. Smaller, sharper sets are easier to verify and easier to actually use.

What this means for you

- **If you're studying on your own:** turn each article you read for class into a 5-question quiz the same day. Doing this within an hour of reading cements the material much better than re-reading alone.
- **If you teach or run training:** build a quick quiz at the end of any handout. It takes about ten minutes per reading, and the answers stay yours to verify before sharing.
- **If you just want to remember what you read:** even a 3-question quiz, done once, beats highlighting the same paragraph three times.

Try it now

Pick one short article you saved recently — anything between 200 and 500 words. Open github.com, start a Copilot chat, paste the article, and ask for 4 multiple-choice questions. Then ask for the answer key. Spend two minutes checking each answer against the original. You'll have a verified quiz before your coffee gets cold.

Getting started with DeepSeek for everyday help

6 steps · Read online

Imagine having a brilliant, patient assistant who doesn't just give you quick answers, but actually sits down and thinks through your trickiest problems step-by-step. By the end of this guide, you will know how to use DeepSeek, a powerful AI tool, to organize your daily life and solve complex tasks, giving you more clarity and saving you time.

Before you start

- **An internet connection:** You'll need to be connected to the internet.
- **A computer or mobile device:** You can access DeepSeek through a web browser on your computer or by downloading their official app on your smartphone or tablet.
- **An email address or phone number:** You will need one of these to create your free DeepSeek account.
- **Rough total time:** This guide should take about 6-8 minutes to follow through completely.

Step 1 — Set up your free account

Your first action is to visit the official DeepSeek website in your web browser or download the DeepSeek app from your device's app store. Once on the site or in the app, you'll see a landing page. Look for a button like **Sign Up** or **Log In**, usually located in the top-right corner or center of the screen. Tap or click this to begin. After choosing to create an account (e.g., with email, Google, or mobile number), you'll be guided through providing your details and verifying them. If it looks different: The buttons might say "Register" or "Create Account". Just pick the option that lets you set up a new account. You'll know it worked when you see a clean, simple chat screen appear, usually with a text box at the bottom ready for your messages.

Step 2 — Turn on "Deep Think"

DeepSeek has a special superpower called **Deep Think**, which is its *reasoning model*. Think of a *reasoning model* like a thoughtful chef who talks through a complex recipe out loud, planning each step before they start chopping, rather than just handing you a plate of food instantly. This mode helps DeepSeek slow down, plan its thoughts, and makes it incredibly accurate for puzzles, math, or tricky organization tasks. On your chat screen, look for a toggle switch or button near the text input box that says **Deep Think**. Click or tap it to turn it on. If it looks different: The toggle might be labeled "Reasoning Mode", "Plan & Execute", or might be hidden under a small settings icon next to the chat box. Look for any option that implies a more thoughtful, step-by-

step approach. You'll know it worked when the toggle switch changes color, moves to an "on" position, or shows a clear indicator that Deep Think is active.

Step 3 — Write your first prompt

Now it's time to write your first *prompt*. A *prompt* is simply the instructions or questions you type to the AI, like giving clear directions to a helpful assistant. Because DeepSeek excels at reasoning, you can ask it complex questions that involve budgets, scheduling, or making difficult decisions. Type your instructions into the text box at the bottom of the screen, ensuring you provide as much detail as possible to help the AI understand your needs. If it looks different: The text box might have placeholder text like "Ask me anything..." or "Type your message here." Example: Copy and paste this prompt into the chat box to try it out:

> "I have a busy Saturday ahead. I need to take the dog to the vet at 9:00am (takes 1 hour), buy groceries (takes 45 minutes), and drop off a birthday present at my sister's house, which is a 20-minute drive from the vet. I also need to be home by 1:00pm for a delivery. Can you organize the perfect, stress-free schedule for me, including realistic travel times?" You'll know it worked when your text appears clearly in the input box, ready to be sent.

Step 4 — Send your prompt and observe the 'thinking'

With your detailed prompt ready in the text box, your next action is to send it to DeepSeek. Look for a "send" button, usually an arrow, paper plane icon, or a button labeled "Send" or "Enter", typically located next to your text box. Click or tap this button. What happens next is a small moment of anticipation. DeepSeek will start to process your request, and you'll often see an indicator showing it's "thinking" or "generating" a response. This process might take a few seconds, especially with Deep Think enabled, as it meticulously plans its answer. If it looks different: The send button might be a simple text label that says "Go" or "Submit." Just click the clear action that makes your message go to the AI. You'll know it worked when your prompt disappears from the input box and appears in the chat history above, and you see an animation or text like "DeepSeek is thinking..." appear.

Step 5 — Review DeepSeek's thought process

Once DeepSeek has finished processing your request, it will display its "thought process" before giving you the final answer. This is a unique and valuable feature. You'll see a small section appear, often collapsible, labeled something like "Thought Process" or "Steps Taken". Your action is to click on this section to expand it. What happens next is fascinating: you'll see a detailed breakdown of how the AI approached your problem, organizing the timeline, double-checking travel distances, and ensuring everything fits your criteria. If it looks different: Look for a small

arrow, a "Show details" button, or "Expand" next to the thought process summary. This might also be represented by a small icon that you click. You'll know it worked when the thought process section opens up, revealing several bullet points or numbered steps explaining the AI's internal logic.

Step 6 — Read the final answer

After reviewing DeepSeek's planning steps, scroll down past the expanded thought process. Your next action is simply to read the final, polished answer or solution that DeepSeek has generated based on its detailed reasoning. What you see is the practical outcome of its "thinking" mode – in our example, a perfectly organized, stress-free schedule for your Saturday. The answer will usually be clearly presented, often using bold text, bullet points, or numbered lists to make it easy to follow. If it looks different: The formatting of the final answer might vary slightly, but the core information will be there. It might be a solid block of text if your prompt was very simple. You'll know it worked when you see the complete, well-structured schedule, or the answer to your question, displayed clearly below DeepSeek's thought process.

Common mistakes

- **Impatience with "Deep Think":** Because Deep Think mode is working hard behind the scenes to calculate the best route or solution, it might take 10 to 15 seconds to start writing. Don't worry—it hasn't frozen! The wait is worth the highly accurate result.
- **Keeping your prompts too simple:** DeepSeek thrives on detail, especially in "Deep Think" mode. If you just ask it to "make a schedule," it has to guess too much. Tell it your preferences, your time limits, and your goals to get the best outcome.
- **Forgetting to enable "Deep Think":** If you're asking a complex question and getting a very quick, but potentially less detailed, answer, double-check that you've remembered to toggle "Deep Think" on. It makes a big difference for intricate tasks.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use DeepSeek to budget your weekly groceries, plan a holiday itinerary with driving times and stops, or get complex topics (like how home loans work) explained in simple, easy-to-understand terms.
- **For your business or work:** You can use it to draft professional emails for tricky situations, solve complex spreadsheet formulas, or brainstorm creative marketing ideas for your local business, knowing it will think through the nuances.
- **If you're just getting started:** Keep the "Deep Think" toggle on for any task that involves planning, problem-solving, or making decisions. Treat it like a friendly colleague who loves helping you double-check your plans and figure things out.

Try it now

Let's test DeepSeek's brainpower right now. Open your new DeepSeek chat, make sure **Deep Think** is toggled on, and send this prompt:

> "Explain the difference between a solar eclipse and a lunar eclipse as if I am a ten-year-old. Use a fun analogy using kitchen items like oranges and torches."

Using Claude to Understand Complex Topics for Study or Work

6 steps · Read online

Feeling overwhelmed by a new subject or a tricky report? Claude can be your personal tutor, helping you unravel complex information into easy-to-grasp insights. This guide will show you how to use Claude to simplify anything from scientific papers to business jargon, making learning less daunting and boosting your confidence.

Before you start

- An Anthropic account. The free tier of Claude is usually enough for these basic explanation tasks.
- Access to the Claude website (claude.ai) on a computer or mobile device.
- Roughly 10-15 minutes to follow along with the steps.

Step 1 — Open Claude and Start a New Chat

Your first step is to open Claude and begin a fresh conversation. This gives you a clean slate to explore your topic. On your device, open your web browser and type `claude.ai` into the address bar, then press Enter. Once the page loads, look for a "New Chat" button or a similar option, often found on the left side of the screen or as a prominent button in the main window. Clicking this will clear any previous conversation you might have had, getting you ready to ask about your complex topic. If it looks different: Claude's interface might vary slightly over time. If you don't see "New Chat", look for an icon like a plus sign (`+`) or a speech bubble to start a new conversation. You'll know it worked when you see a blank message box, ready for your input, usually with "Ask Claude anything" or similar text.

Step 2 — Introduce the Topic

Now it's time to tell Claude what you want to understand. You'll give it a "prompt", which is just the instruction you give to an AI. Think of it like telling a smart assistant exactly what you want it to do. In the message box at the bottom of the screen, type a clear request asking Claude to explain your complex topic. Be specific about the subject. Once you've typed your request, press the Enter key on your keyboard or click the 'Send' button (often a paper airplane icon) next to the message box. Claude will then begin to process your request and generate an initial explanation. 💬 Example: `Explain the concept of 'quantum entanglement' in physics.` You'll know it worked when Claude starts typing out its response directly in the chat window, appearing as a new message above your prompt.

Step 3 — Ask for Simpler Terms

Claude's initial explanation might still use some technical language. To make it truly accessible, you'll ask for "simpler terms" or an "analogy" – explaining something unfamiliar by comparing it to something familiar, like explaining how a computer processes information by comparing it to a kitchen preparing a meal. In the message box, type a follow-up request, building on the previous answer. For instance, you can ask it to rephrase the explanation. Claude will then take its previous response and try to simplify it, often using less technical jargon or more common words. Example: `Can you explain that in simpler terms, like you're talking to a high school student?` If it looks different: If Claude seems to misunderstand, clarify that you want the *previous* explanation rephrased. You'll know it worked when Claude provides a new, less complicated explanation, often using everyday language or a relatable comparison.

Step 4 — Request Examples or Scenarios

Abstract explanations are much easier to grasp when you have concrete examples. This step helps you anchor the concept in real-world scenarios. Type another request in the message box, specifically asking for examples related to your topic. You might want examples from everyday life, or specific scenarios related to your study or work. Claude will then generate a list of examples or describe practical scenarios that illustrate the concept you're learning, helping to solidify your understanding. Example: `Please give me two everyday examples where this concept might apply.` You'll know it worked when Claude provides several distinct examples, often using bullet points or numbered lists, that demonstrate the complex topic in action.

Step 5 — Deepen Understanding with Follow-up Questions

Even with simpler terms and examples, you might still have specific parts of the topic that are unclear. This is where you can dive deeper into specific points. Claude has a "context window," which means it remembers what you've discussed so far in the conversation. Identify any specific terms or ideas from Claude's previous answers that you still find confusing. Type a direct question about that specific point in the message box. Claude will use the existing conversation to provide more detailed clarification on that particular aspect, without you needing to re-explain the whole topic. Example: `You mentioned 'decoherence' in the first explanation. Can you elaborate on what that means specifically?` You'll know it worked when Claude focuses its response precisely on the term or idea you asked about, offering a more in-depth explanation than before.

Step 6 — Summarize and Verify

Finally, it’s a good idea to consolidate your learning by asking for a summary and considering how to cross-reference important information. Remember that Claude, like all AIs, can sometimes experience "hallucinations" – where it confidently makes something up that isn't true or doesn't exist. Type a request for a concise summary of the entire discussion. While Claude

generates this, consider if the topic is critical (e.g., medical advice, financial figures, legal information). For critical topics, always verify the information with reliable sources like textbooks, academic journals, or expert opinions. Claude will provide a brief overview of the key points covered, allowing you to quickly review what you've learned. 💬 Example: `Can you summarise our conversation about quantum entanglement in three short paragraphs?` You'll know it worked when Claude presents a clear, condensed version of the main ideas from your chat.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your initial prompt:** If you just say "Explain physics," Claude won't know where to start. **Fix:** Always be specific, like "Explain the concept of 'black holes' in astrophysics."
- **Overloading Claude with too many questions at once:** Asking for an explanation, examples, and a summary all in one prompt can sometimes lead to less focused answers. **Fix:** Break down your requests into smaller, sequential steps, as shown in this guide.
- **Trusting critical information without verification:** While Claude is a powerful learning tool, it should not be treated as the sole source of truth, especially for sensitive or crucial data. **Fix:** Always cross-reference facts, figures, and important definitions with reputable, human-verified sources to ensure accuracy.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use Claude to understand complex news articles, decode technical terms in product manuals, or get a simpler breakdown of health information from your doctor. It turns confusing information into something you can actually use.
- **For your business or work:** Use Claude to quickly grasp industry reports, understand new software features, or simplify complex legal or financial documents. This can save you time and help you contribute more confidently in meetings.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one confusing email you received or an article you skimmed recently. Copy and paste a paragraph you didn't understand into Claude and ask, "Can you explain this paragraph to me in simple terms?"

Try it now

Find a recent news article about a scientific breakthrough, a new piece of technology, or a complex economic policy. Choose one paragraph that you find particularly hard to understand, then paste it into Claude and ask, "Explain this to me like I'm new to this topic." See how quickly it can clarify things for you!

AI Made Simple: A Gentle First Guide for Beginners

5 steps · Read online

If you've ever felt a bit daunted by new technology, this guide is for you. You'll learn how to confidently use artificial intelligence (AI) to help you with daily tasks, spark creative ideas, and even assist with writing – all while understanding how to keep your personal information safe.

Before you start

- **An internet-connected device:** A computer or tablet offers the easiest experience for typing and seeing the responses clearly. Smartphones work too, but the screen might feel a bit small.
- **A free AI account:** You will need to sign up for a free AI tool like ChatGPT (from OpenAI) or Gemini (from Google) using your email address. This guide focuses on free versions.
- **Stable internet connection:** Ensure you have a reliable internet connection to access the AI.
- **Time:** Allow about 5-10 minutes to follow this guide and complete your first interaction.

Step 1 — Open your AI chat and sign in

Your first step is to open your chosen AI program. Think of these as helpful digital assistants that you can text back and forth with, just like sending a message to a friend. These programs are often called **chatbots** (which is just a fancy name for a computer program designed to have conversations with people).

Open your web browser (like Safari, Chrome, or Edge) and go to the website for ChatGPT or Gemini. Look for a "Log in" or "Sign up" button. If you've never used it before, choose "Sign up" and follow the simple on-screen prompts to create a free account using your email address.

What you see: You'll typically see a clean login page asking for your email and password, or options to sign in with your Google or Apple account. **What happens next:** After successfully logging in or signing up, you'll be taken to the AI's main chat interface, which usually has a large, empty text box at the bottom of the screen. **If it looks different:** If you see a "Download App" option, that's fine too! The steps in the app will be very similar. If you're struggling to find the sign-in, look for words like "Get Started" or "Join for Free". **You'll know it worked when:** You see a clear, simple screen with a large empty box at the bottom, ready for you to type your message.

💬 Example: Type **chatgpt.com** or **gemini.google.com** into your browser's address bar. Then, click "Sign up" and follow the prompts to create your free account.

Step 2 — Find the chat box and say hello

Once you're logged in, you'll be on the main chat screen. This is where you'll interact with the AI. It's usually a very straightforward screen with most of the space dedicated to the conversation area, and a typing box at the bottom. The message you type into the AI is called a **prompt** (the instruction or question you give the AI so it knows how to help you).

To begin, simply click on the large empty text box at the bottom of your screen. This will make your keyboard appear if you're on a tablet or phone, or make a cursor blink if you're on a computer, showing it's ready for you to type. Then, type a simple greeting.

What you see: A large, often white or light-colored, empty box at the bottom of the screen, usually labeled "Message" or "Type your prompt here". **What happens next:** As you type, your message will appear in the box. When you press Enter (or tap a Send button, often an arrow icon), your message will move into the main conversation area, and the AI will begin to process your request. **If it looks different:** The typing box might be at the top of the screen or on the side. Look for the largest area where you can type, usually with a small arrow or "send" button nearby. **You'll know it worked when:** Your greeting (e.g., "Hello!") appears in the main chat area, and the AI responds with its own greeting or acknowledgement.

Example: Type **Hello, how are you today?** into the chat box and press Enter.

Step 3 — Write your first clear question (your 'prompt')

The biggest hurdle for beginners is knowing what to type to the AI. You don't need to use special computer code or keywords. Simply type in full, natural sentences, just as if you were talking to a friendly person who wants to help. The clearer your question (your **prompt**), the better the AI can understand and assist you.

Think about what you want to achieve, then phrase it as a polite request or question. It's like asking a librarian for help: the more detail you give, the better they can guide you. After typing your request, press Enter or click the Send button (often a paper airplane or arrow icon).

What you see: Your previous conversation with the AI, and the empty chat box at the bottom of the screen. **What happens next:** The AI will "think" for a few moments (you might see a typing animation or a loading spinner), then it will generate and display its response directly in the chat window, just above your last message. **If it looks different:** Some AI tools might offer voice input options (a microphone icon). You can try those too, but typing is usually more precise for beginners. If the AI seems confused, try rephrasing your question more simply. **You'll know it worked when:** The AI generates a complete answer to your question, appearing as new text in the conversation history.

💬 Example: Instead of typing short, blunt terms like "scone recipe easy", type: **Could you please share a simple recipe for traditional scones that uses basic ingredients I likely have in my pantry?**

Step 4 — Ask the AI to refine its answer

The AI is incredibly flexible and patient. If the first answer it gives you is too long, too complicated, or not quite right, you can ask it to change the result. You don't need to start a new conversation; just type a follow-up request in the same chat. You can ask it to make things simpler, shorter, or even more fun.

This process of giving feedback and asking for adjustments is called **iterating** (which just means trying again, but with improvements, based on what you learned from the last attempt). Don't be afraid to ask for exactly what you need. Type your request into the same chat box you used before, and press Enter or the Send button.

What you see: The AI's previous answer displayed in the chat, and the empty chat box waiting for your next instruction. **What happens next:** The AI will take your feedback and generate a revised version of its previous answer, incorporating your new instructions. It will display this new answer in the chat below your request. **If it looks different:** Sometimes the AI might apologize if it didn't understand. If this happens, try rephrasing your request for changes even more simply and directly. **You'll know it worked when:** The AI provides a new, updated version of its original answer that better matches what you asked for (e.g., a shorter recipe or a different tone).

💬 Example: If the recipe it gave you looks too detailed, you can type: **That recipe looks good, but could you please simplify it into just five clear, numbered steps?**

Step 5 — Understand what AI can't do (and stay safe)

While AI is a wonderful helper, you must treat it like a polite stranger at a library information desk. They are happy to help you find information, but you would never hand them your bank card or tell them your medical history. The AI lives *only* within its chat window in most cases; it cannot handle sensitive personal data the way a doctor or bank can. (Some newer AI tools can browse the web or interact with applications, but they still operate mainly within their chat interface for everyday use.)

Never type your home address, phone number, passwords, bank details, or private medical worries into an AI. Its primary purpose is to generate text, not to handle sensitive personal data. Protecting your privacy is essential, and the AI cannot truly keep your information private in the way a doctor or bank can.

What you see: Your ongoing conversation with the AI. No changes on screen will indicate a privacy risk, so this step relies on your awareness. **What happens next:** If you stick to safe topics, nothing negative will happen. The AI will continue to provide helpful, general information. If you accidentally share personal data, the AI might even warn you, but it's best not to rely on that. **If it looks different:** Some AI tools have optional privacy settings in your account menu (e.g., "Data & Privacy"). You can explore these, but the core rule of not sharing personal details always applies. **You'll know it worked when:** You feel confident using the AI without worrying about accidentally giving away private information, knowing its limitations regarding sensitive data.

💬 Example:

- **Safe prompt: What are some gentle exercises to help improve balance at home?**
- **Unsafe prompt: My name is Margaret, I live at 12 Main Street, and my doctor just prescribed me this specific medication for my heart...**

Common mistakes

- **Expecting perfect accuracy:** Sometimes AI makes things up with absolute confidence. Tech experts call this a **hallucination** (when an AI confidently invents a false fact or detail). Always double-check important details—like travel times, opening hours, or historical dates—on an official website or trusted source.
- **Using it for medical, financial, or legal decisions:** AI is brilliant for brainstorming dinner ideas or drafting emails, but it is not a doctor, accountant, or lawyer. Always consult real, qualified professionals for medical, legal, or financial advice.
- **Being too vague in your prompt:** If your first attempt at a question doesn't give a good answer, it's often because the AI didn't have enough detail to work with. **Fix:** Instead of "write about dogs", try "Write a short, heartwarming story about a Golden Retriever who helps an elderly neighbor in a small American town."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can easily draft tricky emails to businesses, write warm RSVP notes for family gatherings, or get creative ideas for using up leftovers in your kitchen. It's like having a thoughtful assistant available 24/7.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly organize newsletter articles, write clear meeting agendas, or brainstorm fundraising ideas for your local club. It can help you save time on routine writing tasks.
- **If you're just getting started:** The simplest way to build confidence is to play. Do not worry about saying the "wrong" thing; the AI is infinitely patient and will never judge you. Start with simple questions you know the answer to, just to see how it works.

Try it now

Open your chosen AI tool right now, type this exact sentence into the chat box, and press Enter:

Can you please write a warm RSVP email to my friend Sarah, letting her know I would love to attend her afternoon tea party next Tuesday?

How to pick the right free AI app when you're just getting started

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** All five major free AI apps — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, and Le Chat — can handle the three tasks beginners try most: writing help, answering questions, and coding assistance. They work differently under the hood, but for everyday use the real difference comes down to integrations, conversation style, and how each one fits into your existing tools.

The idea that one AI assistant is simply "the best" is a myth. Each tool is built by a different company, trained in its own way, and optimized for its own strengths. For a beginner, this actually works in your favor — it means there is a good fit for almost every need. This guide walks you through comparing the free tiers of the five most widely available assistants so you can choose with confidence, not guesswork.

Before you start

- An internet connection and any device (phone, tablet, or computer).
- At least one free account — you do not need to pay for anything to follow this guide.
- About 15 minutes to test a few tools side by side.

Step 1 — Decide what you actually want to do

Before looking at any app, name your goal in one sentence. The three tasks beginners try most are:

- **Writing and drafting** — emails, social posts, summaries, brainstorming ideas.
- **Answering questions and explaining things** — looking something up, learning a new topic.
- **Getting help with code** — understanding a programming concept or writing a simple script.

Most free AI apps handle all three reasonably well. The differences show up in *how well* they handle each one, and whether they fit into tools you already use.

💬 Example: "I want to draft a short email to my manager explaining why a project deadline needs to move." You'll know it worked when you can state your goal clearly — that sentence is your comparison checklist.

Step 2 — Compare writing and creative tools

For drafting, editing, and generating ideas, each app takes a different approach.

ChatGPT (OpenAI) and **Gemini** (Google) both produce quick, well-formatted drafts across many formats. They are good all-around choices for everyday writing tasks.

Claude (Anthropic) tends to give longer, more detailed responses and often catches nuance in longer pieces. If you write a lot of reports, emails, or documents, it may feel like a thoughtful editor rather than a speed-draft tool.

Copilot (Microsoft) connects directly to Microsoft Word and Outlook. If you already pay for Microsoft 365, you can generate and edit text inside those apps without switching windows.

Le Chat (Mistral AI) handles multilingual writing naturally — a useful advantage if you work across languages or need content in a language other than English.

All five will produce usable drafts. The question is whether one of these fits more naturally into your existing workflow.

💬 Example prompt to try in two tools: "Write a 150-word product description for a small handmade candle business." You'll know it worked when you can compare the results side by side and spot the style differences — one may be more energetic, another more formal.

Step 3 — Compare question-answering and knowledge tools

When you need an answer rather than a draft, the tools differ most on two points: how current the information is, and how deeply they explain.

Gemini draws on Google's search infrastructure for real-time information. If your question involves recent events, current prices, or anything time-sensitive, it may have an edge here on the free tier.

ChatGPT and **Claude** have knowledge cutoff dates — they do not browse the live web the same way. They explain concepts in depth and handle follow-up questions particularly well, making them strong for learning and research conversations.

Copilot uses the same underlying model as ChatGPT but displays search results alongside its answer, which some users find helpful for verifying factual claims.

Le Chat handles questions in multiple languages fluidly and can switch between them mid-conversation.

If your primary need is quick, up-to-date answers, try Gemini for that task. For learning and exploring a topic over several questions, ChatGPT or Claude may feel more natural.

💬 Example prompt: "Explain what a budget spreadsheet is to someone who has never made one." You'll know it worked when the explanation uses everyday language and builds on ideas step by step — not when it throws jargon at you.

Step 4 — Compare coding and learning tools

If you are curious about how code works or want help writing a simple script, here is how the tools line up.

ChatGPT and **Copilot** both generate code snippets with plain-language explanations. Copilot's advantage shows up if you write code inside Microsoft development tools — the integration is built in.

Claude tends to explain code in more detail and can walk through longer programs step by step, which some beginners find helpful.

Le Chat supports a wide range of programming languages and can switch between them in the same conversation.

Gemini integrates with Google tools and works well for web-related code and simpler scripts.

None of the free tiers are full development environments — they will not run your code for you. But for understanding, learning, and writing small scripts, all five are worth trying.

💬 Example prompt: "Write a simple Python script that asks for your name and prints a greeting." You'll know it worked when you can copy the result, paste it into a free online Python editor, and run it without errors.

Step 5 — Make your decision in three questions

After testing all five tools with the same prompt, answer three quick questions to narrow your choice:

1. Which response felt most natural to read?
2. Did any tool integrate with an app you already use (Microsoft 365, Google Workspace)?
3. Did any tool answer in the language or style you preferred?

Write the answers down. If you are a writer or content creator, you will likely lean toward ChatGPT or Gemini for their versatility. If you already use Microsoft tools every day, Copilot removes friction by living where you already work. If you value thoughtful, detailed responses, Claude may feel like the best fit. If you work across languages or want a tool that switches easily between them, Le Chat is worth a closer look.

💬 Example: After comparing results from Steps 2 through 4, note which tool you would open first if you had a real task due tomorrow. You'll know it worked when you feel a clear pull toward one tool for one specific reason — that is a sign the fit is right, not just familiarity.

Common mistakes

- **Assuming one tool beats all others.** Every comparison you read online reflects one person's use case. Your needs may be different. The tools are genuinely close in quality for most everyday tasks.
- **Missing tools you already have access to.** If you already pay for Microsoft 365, Copilot may already be on your computer. If you have a Google account, Gemini is a free web app. Check your existing subscriptions before signing up for something new.
- **Sticking with the first tool you try.** First impressions vary. A tool that felt awkward at first may click once you adjust how you phrase your prompts. If a tool almost worked, try rephrasing before switching.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A good AI assistant can cut the time you spend staring at a blank page, wrestling with an unfamiliar topic, or figuring out where to start on a task. The right tool makes that feel easy rather than frustrating.
- **For your business or work:** If you handle any written communication, internal documents, or basic research as part of your job, even a free AI assistant can take the first draft off your plate. The best fit is the one that connects to the tools you already use.
- **If you are just getting started:** Pick one tool and commit to using it for three real tasks this week. At the end of the week, ask yourself whether it felt natural. If yes, keep going. If not, try the next one on this list.

Try it now

Open two of the five tools in separate tabs or windows right now. Paste the same prompt into both:

> "Give me three ideas for a weekend project I could finish in two hours with no special skills or tools."

Compare the results side by side. Notice the differences in tone, length, and creativity. That feeling of "this one speaks my language" is your signal. Trust it — and open that one first next time you have a task to tackle.

How to study and learn faster with AI – a beginner's step-by-step guide

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to ask an AI to break down a tough topic, create a handy summary, and build a short quiz – so you can master new material quicker than before. This guide is written for anyone who wants to study smarter, not harder, by using a free digital learning assistant.

Before you start

- **An active internet connection** and a web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge).
- **A free OpenAI ChatGPT account.** You'll use this popular AI tool as our example. If you don't have one, you'll create one in Step 1.
- **A device** such as a computer, laptop, tablet, or smartphone. The steps are written for a web browser experience, but the concepts apply to mobile apps too.
- **A way to take notes** (either pen and paper or a digital note-taking app) to write down your quiz answers.
- **Rough total time:** Allow about 15-20 minutes to go through all the steps and try them out with your own topic.

Step 1 — Set up your AI chat

First, open your web browser and go to the AI chat website. For this guide, we'll use ChatGPT, a **large language model (LLM)** – which is essentially a powerful computer program trained on a huge amount of text, allowing it to understand and generate human-like language. You'll need to sign in, or create a free account if you don't have one yet.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank text box ready for your message, usually at the bottom of the screen.

Example: Visit `https://chat.openai.com`. On the first page, click the "Sign up" button. Follow the prompts to enter your email, create a password, and verify your email address. You may also need to provide your name and date of birth. After completing the short setup, you'll land on the main chat interface. If it looks different, look for "Log In" or "Sign Up" usually in the top-right corner or center of the screen.

Step 2 — Ask for a plain-language explanation

Now that you're in the chat, think of a subject you want to understand better – maybe "photosynthesis" from biology or "supply-chain logistics" for a business course. Type a clear instruction, called a **prompt**, into the text box that tells the AI exactly what you need. Make sure to specify the level of detail, like asking it to explain it "simply" or "like I'm a beginner."

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing out an explanation in response to your message, appearing just above your prompt.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Explain photosynthesis in simple terms, like I'm a high-school student with no science background.
```

Then, press the 'Enter' key on your keyboard or click the 'Send message' button (often a paper plane icon) next to the text box.

Step 3 — Request a bullet-point summary

After getting a basic description, it's helpful to condense the main ideas. This makes it easier to remember the core concepts. In the same chat, ask the AI to summarize the key points into a short, easy-to-read list. This helps you grasp the structure of the topic at a glance, like creating a quick cheat sheet for yourself.

You'll know it worked when the AI presents a concise, numbered or bulleted list directly below your request, making the key information easy to skim.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Summarize the main steps of photosynthesis in 5 bullet points.
```

If it looks different, and the summary isn't quite right, try being more specific, for example: "Can you re-summarize that for me, focusing only on the cause and effect, in three short sentences?"

Step 4 — Create a quick practice quiz

Testing yourself is one of the fastest ways to figure out what you've actually learned and what you still need to review. Ask the AI to generate a few questions based on the summary it just provided. This step turns passive reading into active recall, which is a proven technique for strengthening your memory and understanding. You can choose the type of quiz, like multiple-choice or short answer.

You'll know it worked when the AI displays a short list of questions, each with several options to choose from, or a clear question with space for your answer.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Make three multiple-choice questions about the bullet-point summary of photosynthesis.
Include one correct answer and three distractors for each question.
```

If it looks different, and the questions aren't in the format you wanted, rephrase your prompt to specify, for instance: "Instead, can you make three open-ended questions?"

Step 5 — Check your answers and get clarification

Now that you have your quiz, write down your answers on a piece of paper or in your notes app. Once you're done, type your answers back into the chat. Then, ask the AI to tell you which ones were correct and, importantly, why any wrong answers were incorrect. This feedback loop helps to correct misunderstandings and deepens your knowledge, converting a guess into solid understanding.

You'll know it worked when the AI clearly identifies which of your answers were correct and provides explanations for any you got wrong, or expands on the right ones.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Here are my answers to the photosynthesis quiz: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C. Which are correct, and
can you explain any mistakes?
```

If it looks different, and the AI seems confused, make sure your answers are clearly formatted (e.g., "Question 1: A, Question 2: B") so it can easily understand what you're checking.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague with your prompt:** Asking "Explain photosynthesis" without specifying the audience can give you a textbook-dense reply that's hard to digest.
    - **The fix:** Always add context like "in simple language," "for a beginner," or "like I'm in primary school."
- **Skipping the quiz or checking answers:** It's tempting to just read the summary and move on. Without actively testing yourself, you won't truly know which gaps remain in your understanding.
    - **The fix:** Treat the quiz and answer check as a critical part of the learning process. It forces your brain to retrieve information, which solidifies memory.

- **Relying solely on one AI answer:** AI tools can occasionally **hallucinate** (confidently make up facts or information that isn't true). While usually accurate, it's not infallible.
    - **The fix:** If something feels off or incredibly important, copy the same question into a new chat, or search a reliable source (like a textbook or reputable website) to verify the information.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Want to understand your mortgage statement, a complex news article, or a new cooking recipe? Use the exact same steps – ask for a plain explanation, a short list of key points, then a quick quiz to lock in your understanding. It's like having a personal expert on standby.
- **For your business or work:** Turn a complex report or industry jargon into a one-page briefing for your team, and follow it with a short quiz to ensure everyone is on the same page about new procedures or project goals.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to pick a current study topic, ask the AI for a simple explanation, and then see how the summary looks. You'll instantly feel the benefit of having a personal tutor on demand.

Try it now

Open your AI chat tool, pick the subject you're studying this week, and type the first prompt from Step 2. In the next two minutes, you'll have a clear, beginner-friendly explanation right in front of you – the essential first step towards faster, more effective learning.

Using Perplexity AI for Quick Study Summaries and Exam Prep

5 steps · Read online

Imagine having a tireless study assistant that doesn't just summarize your textbook, but actually shows you exactly where it found the answers. This guide will show you how to use Perplexity AI to create trustworthy study guides, clear explainers, and practice quizzes for any subject, helping you get ready for assessments with confidence. Perplexity is an **AI-powered search engine** (a smart online tool that uses artificial intelligence to find information) that searches the live internet to find up-to-date information, unlike some traditional tools that rely only on what they learned during training.

Before you start

- **A device with an internet connection:** You'll need a computer, tablet, or smartphone to access Perplexity AI.
- **A free Perplexity account:** You can easily sign up on their website with your email address. The basic, free plan provides access to the core features needed for this guide, including a limited number of "Copilot" queries per day, which offers more interactive help.
- **Rough total time:** This guide should take you about 10-15 minutes to follow along with and complete your first summary and quiz.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity AI and get ready to search

Your first step is to open the Perplexity AI website or launch the app on your device. This will take you to the main interface where you can start asking questions.

When you open Perplexity, you'll see a clean homepage with a prominent search bar in the center of the screen, often displaying a helpful prompt like "Ask anything...". After the page loads, you'll be ready to type your first query. If you're using the mobile app, the layout will be similar, but the search bar might be closer to the bottom. You'll know it worked when the Perplexity homepage or search interface is clearly visible on your screen.

Step 2 — Choose your search focus

Before typing your study question, you can guide Perplexity on where to search by using its "Focus" feature. This is like telling a librarian which section of the library you're interested in.

You'll usually see a button labeled "Focus" or a dropdown menu near the main search bar, sometimes with the default "All" selected. Tapping or clicking this will open a list of options such as "Academic", "Writing", "YouTube", and "Reddit". When you select one, a small icon or text

will appear next to the search bar indicating your choice. If it looks different, look for a similar option in the bottom-left corner of the screen (on desktop) or within a "Settings" menu (on mobile apps). You'll know it worked when your chosen focus (e.g., "Academic") is displayed next to the search bar. Example: Click on the **Focus** button and select **Academic** if you are preparing an essay for a history or science topic.

Step 3 — Craft a clear question (prompt)

To get the best study summaries, you need to write a clear **prompt** (the instruction you give to an AI). Think of it like giving precise instructions to a diligent research assistant.

Type your detailed question into the search bar. For study purposes, tell Perplexity what topic you want to learn and exactly how you want the information organized (e.g., "as a comparison table," "in bullet points"). After typing, press the 'Enter' key or click the 'Search' button. Perplexity will then begin to process your request, often showing a "Generating" message. If the AI doesn't understand, it might ask a clarifying question, in which case you can rephrase your prompt. You'll know it worked when Perplexity starts typing out a summary or explanation based on your specific request. Example: "I am a biology student preparing for an exam. Summarize the key differences between mitosis and meiosis. Present this as a simple comparison table followed by bullet points explaining the main phases of each."

Step 4 — Review and verify sources (citations)

One of the main challenges with AI is **hallucination** (when an AI confidently makes up incorrect information). Perplexity helps you beat this by providing **citations** (direct links to the original website where it found the information).

Inside the summary Perplexity generates, you will see small numbers in brackets (like [1], [2]) next to facts. These are clickable links. Click on one of these numbers to open the original source website in a new browser tab. After the new tab loads, quickly scan the original source to verify that the AI has accurately summarized the information. If it looks different, ensure your browser isn't blocking pop-ups, or try right-clicking the number to open the link in a new tab manually. You'll know it worked when you can see the original article or document that Perplexity used for that specific piece of information.

Step 5 — Generate a self-test quiz

The best way to prepare for an exam is through **active recall** (testing your memory rather than just rereading your notes). You can ask Perplexity to turn the summary it just made into a quick multiple-choice quiz.

Once your summary is complete, type a follow-up question into the same chat window, asking Perplexity to create a quiz. The AI will then read its previous response and generate questions based on that content. You'll see the questions appear in your chat, often with multiple-choice options. If it provides answers immediately, simply ask it to hide them. You'll know it worked when you see a list of numbered questions, usually with options (A, B, C, D), ready for you to test your knowledge. 💬 Example: "Based on the summary of cell division you just created, write a 5-question multiple-choice quiz. Hide the answers at the very bottom of your response so I cannot see them while I test myself."

Common mistakes

- **Blindly trusting the summary:** Even the best AI can misinterpret or make up information.
    - **Fix:** Always click at least one or two of the bracketed citations ([1], [2]) to cross-reference the information with the original source. It's like checking the references in a textbook.
- **Being too vague in your prompt:** If you just ask for "American history," you'll get a very generic, long wall of text.
    - **Fix:** Be specific about the era, topic, or event you are studying. Include keywords like "summarize," "explain," or "compare" to guide the AI.
- **Forgetting to export your best summaries:** Perplexity saves your chat history, but it's wise to keep important study notes elsewhere.
    - **Fix:** After a useful summary or quiz is generated, copy and paste the text into a document on your computer (like Google Docs or Microsoft Word) or a note-taking app to save it for later review.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly research any hobby, household project, or local news story with reliable, verified facts in seconds, getting accurate answers to your curious questions.
- **For your business or work:** You can efficiently research industry trends, market competitors, or new regulations, knowing exactly where the data came from and that it's up-to-date.
- **If you're just getting started:** Use Perplexity as a super-fast, reliable starting point for any research task to get your head around difficult topics without getting lost in endless search results.

Try it now

Open Perplexity AI and ask it: "What are the main stages of photosynthesis, presented as a bulleted list with simple explanations for each stage?" Make sure to click at least one citation to verify a fact.

The main AI assistants explained simply (and what each is best at)

4 steps · Read online

If you've ever felt overwhelmed by the growing number of AI assistants on the market, this guide is for you. We'll help you spot the right one for your everyday tasks by exploring their unique strengths. You'll learn how to identify which AI is best suited for different situations, from writing help to quick research.

Before you start

- **Internet connection:** You'll need a stable internet connection and a web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari) to access most of these tools. Many also offer free mobile apps for your smartphone or tablet.
- **Free account:** Most of the assistants we mention offer a "free tier" or trial, which lets you try them out without spending any money. You'll usually need to create a free account with an email address.
- **Device:** You can follow along using a computer, laptop, tablet, or smartphone. The screens might look slightly different, but the core steps remain the same.
- **Time commitment:** This guide will take roughly 5-7 minutes to read and understand. You can spend an extra 5-10 minutes trying out one or two of the assistants for yourself after reading.

Step 1 — Meet the friendly all-rounders (ChatGPT and Gemini)

These assistants are like versatile pocket-knives, great for a wide range of tasks. Both run on a **large language model (LLM)** – think of this as the AI's "brain" that lets it understand your questions and generate human-like text responses. Your action here is to mentally consider how these tools work.

When you open ChatGPT (from OpenAI) or Gemini (from Google), you'll typically see a clean chat window, often with a large text box at the bottom where you type your questions or "prompts." After you type your request and press Enter, the AI will start generating text in response. If the screen looks different, don't worry – most AI chat tools will have a clear input area marked "Ask me anything," "Type your message," or similar.

💬 Example: "Give me a step-by-step plan to organize my garage this weekend, including how to categorise items."

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing out its response to your prompt, offering suggestions for your garage organization. While these tools can draft plans, they can't physically

tidy your garage for you!

Step 2 — Use the work-and-writing specialists (Claude and Copilot)

If your main need is professional writing or office-based tasks, these assistants are designed to shine. Your action in this step is to imagine using one of these for a work-related task.

For Claude (from Anthropic), you'll find a similar chat interface to the all-rounders, usually with a clear text input box. When you enter a prompt asking for help with writing or summarizing, Claude will generate a response, often known for its thoughtful and natural tone. If you're using Copilot (from Microsoft), you won't typically open a separate app; instead, you'll see a small "Copilot" icon or button appear directly within Microsoft Office apps like Word, Excel, or Outlook. Tapping this often opens a side panel where you can chat with the AI about the document you're working on.

💬 Example: "Read this draft email to my landlord and help me make the tone more polite but firm."

You'll know it worked when Claude gives you a refined version of your email or Copilot, within your Office app, offers suggestions directly relevant to your document. Note that Copilot's deeper integration might require a specific Microsoft 365 subscription. These tools can polish your words, but they can't actually send the email or write the entire report from scratch without your input.

Step 3 — Try the search and social discoverers (Perplexity and Grok)

When you need facts, summaries from the web, or insights into the latest trends, these assistants act like research helpers. Your action for this step is to understand how these tools gather and present information differently from a standard search engine.

If you open Perplexity, you'll typically see a straightforward search bar, much like a regular internet search engine. After you type your question, instead of just a list of links, Perplexity will present a clear, summarized answer based on its web search, complete with footnotes or links to the sources it used. For Grok (from xAI), which is linked to the X platform (formerly Twitter), you might access it via the X app or a dedicated Grok interface. It will provide real-time summaries of news, public opinion, or trending topics as they happen on the platform.

💬 Example: "What are the latest updates on the local public transport extensions, and where can I read the official announcements?"

You'll know it worked when Perplexity provides a concise answer with clickable source links, or Grok presents a summary of current discussions and news related to your query. While these tools are great for summarizing information, they don't perform actual investigative journalism or verify the ultimate truth of every piece of content they find.

Step 4 — Explore international options (Qwen and DeepSeek)

Beyond the most well-known names, there are powerful AI assistants developed by companies around the world, each with unique strengths. Your action here is to consider these tools for tasks that might benefit from specialized capabilities like language translation or complex reasoning.

When you access Qwen (from Alibaba) or DeepSeek, you'll generally encounter a familiar chat interface. For Qwen, after you input text, it excels at translating and understanding cultural nuances, particularly across Asian languages. DeepSeek often stands out for its strong abilities in logical problem-solving, mathematics, and coding assistance. The screen usually features a clear chat history and a text input area at the bottom.

💬 Example: "Translate this business greeting into polite conversational Japanese and explain any cultural etiquette I should keep in mind."

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a translation that feels culturally appropriate, or delivers a well-reasoned answer to a complex, logical problem. These assistants can provide sophisticated language and reasoning help, but they cannot replace a human expert for critical cross-cultural communication or advanced coding projects.

Common mistakes

- **Assuming perfect accuracy:** AI can sometimes "hallucinate" – meaning it confidently generates incorrect or made-up facts. Always double-check critical information like dates, legal details, medical advice, or statistics, as the AI cannot guarantee truth.
- **Stopping after the first answer:** If the AI's first response isn't quite right, don't give up! Treat the assistant like a conversation partner. Guide it by saying, "That's a bit too formal – can you make it sound friendlier?" or "Can you expand on point number three?"
- **Using overly vague prompts:** Giving the AI too little detail can lead to generic or unhelpful answers. Instead of "Write a story," try "Write a short, uplifting story about a shy koala who learns to sing, set in a misty rainforest, for children aged 5-7."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use Gemini to find a recipe from the ingredients you already have in your fridge, or consider Claude to craft a heartfelt birthday card with just the right tone.

- **For your business or work:** Let Copilot summarize long meeting notes directly inside your document, or have ChatGPT draft social media posts to free up your creative time for other tasks.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one assistant that seems most appealing, spend a few minutes exploring its interface and trying a simple prompt, then gradually add more tools to your digital toolkit as you become comfortable.

Try it now

Open a free account with **ChatGPT** or **Gemini** in your web browser right now. Look for the large text box at the bottom of the screen, then copy and paste this prompt to see how the assistant responds: *"Write a friendly three-sentence reminder for my neighbor about the upcoming rubbish collection day."* You'll know it worked when the AI generates a response directly in the chat window.

How to use Meta AI inside WhatsApp – step-by-step for beginners

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to ask Meta AI for answers, recipe ideas, or quick drafts right from your WhatsApp conversation, even if you've never used AI before. This is perfect for anyone who wants to quickly tap into AI without switching between apps.

Before you start

- You need a WhatsApp account set up on your phone (either an iPhone running iOS or an Android device).
- Your WhatsApp app should be updated to its latest version, as this often brings new features like the Meta AI button.
- Meta AI is generally a free feature within WhatsApp, so you won't need a paid plan for this guide.
- You should be comfortable tapping a few icons and typing messages, no coding or special skills are needed.
- This guide will take roughly 5-10 minutes to follow all the steps and try out your first AI chat.

Step 1 — Find the Meta AI chat

To begin, open your WhatsApp application on your phone. Look for a circular button, usually green with a small sparkle or star icon, often located at the bottom-right or top-right of your main Chats screen. This is the quick way to start a new chat with Meta AI. If you don't see this sparkle button, you can also tap the **Search** bar at the top of your screen. **What you see:** A green circle with a sparkle icon, or the "Search" bar. **What happens next:** Tapping the sparkle button usually opens a direct chat with Meta AI. If using the search bar, it will show results as you type. **If it looks different:** If the sparkle button isn't there, simply tap the **Search** bar at the top of your Chats screen and proceed with the example. Apps can look a bit different depending on your phone or recent updates. 💬 Example: Type "Meta AI" into the search bar. **You'll know it worked when:** You see "Meta AI" appear in your search results or as a chat option, often with a distinctive robot-like avatar or a similar sparkle icon next to its name.

Step 2 — Start your first conversation

Once you've found "Meta AI" (either through the sparkle button or search), tap on its name to open the chat window. This is just like starting a conversation with a friend. You'll likely see a welcome message explaining what Meta AI can do. To activate the AI, you need to send it your

first message. **What you see:** The Meta AI chat screen with a welcome message from the AI, and a message typing box at the bottom. **What happens next:** After sending your message, Meta AI will process it using a **Large Language Model (LLM)** – think of an LLM as a very smart, digital brain that understands and generates human-like text. It will then type a response back to you. **If it looks different:** Instead of a "Start chat" button, you might just be able to type directly into the message box. This is normal. 💬 Example: Type "Hi Meta AI, what can you do?" and press the send button (usually a paper plane icon). **You'll know it worked when:** Meta AI sends a friendly greeting or an explanation of its capabilities in reply to your message.

Step 3 — Ask a question or give a task

Now that you've started the conversation, it's time to ask Meta AI for something specific. This instruction you give is called a **prompt**. The clearer and more detailed your prompt, the better and more useful Meta AI's response will be. Think of it as telling a helpful assistant exactly what you need. **What you see:** Your prompt appears in the chat, and a "typing..." indicator usually shows that Meta AI is working on its response. **What happens next:** Meta AI will generate an answer, idea, or draft based on your prompt and display it in the chat. This process usually takes a few seconds. **If it looks different:** Sometimes the AI replies almost instantly, without a "typing..." indicator. This is fine – it just means it's processed your request very quickly. 💬 Example: Type "What's a simple, healthy breakfast idea I can make in under 5 minutes?" and send it. **You'll know it worked when:** Meta AI's detailed response appears in the chat window, directly addressing your question.

Step 4 — Use the AI's reply

Once Meta AI has generated its response, you have several options for how to use the information. You can copy the text, forward it to another chat, or simply read it and continue the conversation. For now, let's try copying the response so you can paste it anywhere you like. **What you see:** Meta AI's reply is displayed in the chat. Next to or below the message, you might see small icons like an arrow to forward, or you can often tap and hold the message for more options. **What happens next:** The selected text will be copied to your phone's clipboard, ready for you to paste into a note, an email, or another WhatsApp chat. **If it looks different:** If you don't see a specific "copy" button, try tapping and holding Meta AI's message. A small menu should pop up with options, including "Copy". 💬 Example: Tap and hold Meta AI's breakfast recipe, then choose "Copy" from the menu that appears. **You'll know it worked when:** You can switch to another app (like your notes app) and successfully paste the recipe text there. Remember, Meta AI can draft the message, but it can't send it to other people for you.

Step 5 — Keep the conversation flowing

Meta AI remembers what you've discussed earlier in the same chat. This is called its **context window** – think of it like the AI's short-term memory for your current conversation. You can ask follow-up questions or refine your previous request without having to repeat all the details. **What you see:** Your new follow-up question in the chat, appearing below Meta AI's last reply. **What happens next:** Meta AI will consider your new question in light of everything you've talked about so far in this chat. It will then provide a response that builds on the previous information. **If it looks different:** If the AI seems to "forget" an earlier detail, it might be due to the context window reaching its limit, or your follow-up prompt might be too vague. Just try rephrasing your question with a little more detail. 💬 Example: After getting the breakfast idea, type "Can you suggest some healthy lunch ideas too, keeping the 5-minute prep time in mind?" and send. **You'll know it worked when:** Meta AI provides new lunch ideas that are specifically quick and healthy, without you having to re-explain those requirements.

Step 6 — Start a fresh chat for a new topic

If you want to discuss something completely different that isn't related to your current conversation, it's a good idea to start a brand new chat with Meta AI. This clears its "memory" and gives you a fresh start, ensuring the AI focuses entirely on your new topic. **What you see:** Your main WhatsApp "Chats" screen again. **What happens next:** Tapping the sparkle icon will open a new, blank chat window with Meta AI, ready for a completely unrelated conversation. **If it looks different:** If you can't find the sparkle icon, you might need to go back to the WhatsApp "Chats" screen, then tap the "new chat" icon (usually a speech bubble or a pen-and-paper icon) and select "Meta AI" from your contacts list. 💬 Example: Go back to your main WhatsApp "Chats" screen, then tap the green sparkle icon or the "new chat" icon to begin a fresh conversation. **You'll know it worked when:** The new Meta AI chat opens with a fresh welcome message, indicating a clean slate for your next topic.

Common mistakes

- **Not finding the Meta AI chat:** Sometimes the sparkle button isn't immediately visible, or you might overlook the search bar.
    - **The fix:** Always try the **Search** bar at the top of your WhatsApp Chats screen and type "Meta AI". It will appear in your contacts. Also, ensure your WhatsApp app is fully updated, as new features roll out in versions.
- **Using vague prompts:** Asking things like "Help me with work" is too broad, and Meta AI won't know where to start.
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Provide context, keywords, or examples. For instance, "Draft a short email to my team about our meeting on Friday" is much better.
- **Expecting unlimited memory:** While Meta AI remembers your current chat, it doesn't remember previous chats or things from days ago.

    - **The fix:** If you're switching to a completely new topic or continuing a discussion from a long time ago, start a new chat (see Step 6) and provide all the necessary context in your first prompt.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Need a quick travel tip, a joke for a group chat, or a summarized news headline? Just type it into WhatsApp and Meta AI does the heavy lifting, giving you instant information or creative sparks without leaving your messaging app.
- **For your business or work:** Draft a short client email, get a bullet-point outline for a meeting agenda, or brainstorm taglines for a project without needing to open a separate writing tool. It's a quick assistant right in your pocket.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is simply sending a friendly "Hello Meta AI" and seeing its response. This requires no extra apps or sign-ups beyond your existing WhatsApp account.

Try it now

In the next two minutes, open WhatsApp, find "Meta AI" using the sparkle button or the search bar, send the message "What's a fun weekend activity for two people near the beach?" and glance at the answer. You've just taken your first step into AI-powered chatting!

A Beginner's Guide to Using ChatGPT Voice for Hands-Free Tasks

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to start a spoken conversation with ChatGPT and get it to help you cook, drive, or tidy up – all without lifting a finger. This is perfect for anyone who wants a little extra help while multitasking and keeping their hands free.

Before you start

- **ChatGPT app installed:** You'll need the official ChatGPT app on your smartphone or tablet (available for iPhone and Android devices).
- **OpenAI account:** Make sure you're signed in with your OpenAI account. This feature is available on both free and paid plans, though paid users might get access to newer voice models sooner.
- **Quiet spot:** For the best experience, choose a place with minimal background noise so your device can hear your voice clearly.
- **Rough time commitment:** This entire process should take about 5-10 minutes to set up and try your first conversation.

Step 1 — Start the voice conversation

Open the ChatGPT app on your device. Once the main chat screen loads, you'll see a text input box at the bottom. To activate the voice mode, **tap the voice icon** located in the bottom-right corner, next to where you'd normally type your message. This is typically represented by a waveform or sound wave symbol. Tapping it switches the app into *real-time voice* – meaning you can speak to the AI and hear its reply instantly, much like a phone call.

If it looks different: The icon might sometimes move slightly due to app updates, but it's typically in the bottom-right area. Look for a waveform symbol or a microphone icon that suggests voice interaction.

You'll know it worked when a new screen appears with a dynamic animation (often a colorful wave or line) that responds to sound, indicating it's ready to listen.

Step 2 — Choose a voice you like

When you use the voice mode for the very first time, the app will usually present a list of sample voices for ChatGPT to use. **Tap on each option** to hear a short demo of the different tones and accents available, then **select your favorite** by tapping the "Choose" button (or a similar selection option). This voice will be used for all future spoken interactions.

If it looks different: If you don't see the voice selection screen, it means a default voice is already set. You can change this later by going to the ChatGPT app's main "Settings" menu (usually found by tapping your profile picture in the top-left or bottom-left corner of the main chat screen) and looking for a "Speech" or "Voice" option under the ChatGPT settings.

You'll know it worked when the screen transitions from the voice selection menu to the main listening indicator, confirming your chosen voice has been saved.

Step 3 — Give your first spoken instruction

The screen will now display a simple listening indicator – typically a wave animation or a microphone icon – letting you know ChatGPT is ready for your input. **Speak your first *prompt* naturally**, as if you were talking to a friend. A *prompt* is simply the instruction, question, or statement you give to the AI. There's no need to press any button while you talk; the app automatically detects when you've finished speaking based on pauses.

💬 Example: "Hi! I'm planning a weekend trip to the Blue Ridge Mountains. Can you suggest some scenic bushwalks that are good for beginners?"

If it looks different: If the listening indicator doesn't seem to react to your voice, check your phone's microphone permissions for the ChatGPT app in your device's main settings. You might also need to speak a little louder or clearer if you're in a noisy environment.

You'll know it worked when the dynamic animation responds to your voice as you speak, and then after a brief pause, you'll see your words appear as text on the screen, ready for ChatGPT to process.

Step 4 — Hear the reply and respond

After you finish speaking and your words appear on screen, the ChatGPT app will pause briefly to process your request. Then, in your chosen voice, it will **speak the answer back to you**. Listen carefully to the response. Once the AI has finished its reply, the listening indicator will reappear automatically. Simply **speak your follow-up question or comment** immediately – you don't need to tap the screen or press any buttons to continue the conversation.

💬 Example: "Those sound great! What's the best way to get to the Wentworth Falls track if I'm coming from Chicago?"

If it looks different: If the AI cuts off or mishears you, just say "Could you please repeat that?" or "I wasn't finished, sorry!" and continue. Sometimes, a strong accent or background noise can make it difficult for the AI to understand everything perfectly.

You'll know it worked when the AI responds directly to your follow-up, seamlessly continuing the dialogue as if you were talking to a person.

Step 5 — Control your spoken conversation

While you're chatting with ChatGPT, you have a few ways to manage the conversation. If you need it to **pause** while it's speaking, you can simply say "Stop" or "Hold on." To manually **end the entire voice conversation** and return to the text chat screen, look for a prominent 'X' icon or a 'Stop' button that usually appears on the screen during the voice session. Tapping this will close the voice interface.

Example: (While ChatGPT is explaining) "ChatGPT, hold on a moment please."

If it looks different: The exact look and placement of the 'X' or 'Stop' button might vary slightly depending on your device or app version, but it's typically easy to spot. If you can't find it, you can always close the app entirely and reopen it to reset the session.

You'll know it worked when the AI pauses its reply immediately, or when the voice interface closes and you return to the standard text chat screen.

Step 6 — Go fully hands-free

Now that you know how to start and control a voice conversation, you can truly go hands-free! **Place your phone on a kitchen bench**, slip it into a pocket, or set it on the car console. The voice mode is designed to keep listening for your commands and responses, even if the screen dims. You can now use ChatGPT as a constant companion for various tasks without needing to interact with the screen.

Example: "Okay ChatGPT, tell me a short mystery story, but pause every two minutes so I can guess the suspect."

If it looks different: If the AI stops responding when the screen dims, check your phone's power-saving settings; some modes can restrict background app activity. Ensure you have a stable internet connection, as dropped signals can interrupt the conversation.

You'll know it worked when you can continue to ask questions, receive answers, and have a natural back-and-forth with ChatGPT, all while your hands are busy with other activities.

Common mistakes

- **Pausing too long mid-sentence:** The AI may think you're finished and start responding, which can interrupt your thoughts.

    - **Fix:** If this happens, simply say "Hold on, I wasn't done yet" and continue speaking. The AI is usually forgiving and will pick up where you left off.
- **Background noise:** Loud noises like a running tap, frying pans, or traffic can confuse your phone's microphone, making it hard for ChatGPT to understand you.
    - **Fix:** Using earbuds with a built-in microphone helps a lot, as they focus on your voice and filter out ambient sounds.
- **Using keyword strings:** You don't need to speak like a search query (e.g., "Recipe pumpkin chicken fast"). This isn't how conversational AI works.
    - **Fix:** Talk naturally, using full sentences and common language. ChatGPT's language model is designed to understand everyday speech patterns, making your interactions much smoother.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Turn mundane chores like washing dishes, tidying up, or gardening into moments for learning. Ask for recipe ideas, quick facts, shopping list additions, or even play an interactive game – all without needing to touch your phone.
- **For your business or work:** Dictate initial drafts of emails, practice a presentation out loud, or simply think through a complex problem while you're commuting or taking a walk. It can act as a sounding board, helping you organize your thoughts.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try using the voice feature while you're cooking. It keeps the screen clean of sticky fingers and makes the kitchen a more interactive and helpful space. ChatGPT can read out ingredients, convert measurements, or even suggest substitutions on the fly.

Try it now

Grab your phone, open the ChatGPT app, and tap the voice icon in the bottom-right corner. Once the listening screen appears, say:

> "Hi! I have leftover roast chicken, half a pumpkin and some spinach. What quick dinner can I make?"

You'll hear the AI's suggestion right away – that's your first step into having a hands-free conversation with AI!

Organize your work with Claude Projects – a step-by-step beginner's guide

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a brand-new Claude Project that holds all your relevant chats and documents, and you'll know how to ask Claude to draw on everything at once. It's ideal for anyone who wants a clean, goal-focused AI workspace without needing any technical background.

Before you start

- **Claude account:** Sign up for a free Anthropic Claude account (you'll need an email and a password).
- **Device:** A desktop or laptop with a modern web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari).
- **Plan:** Projects are available on Claude — check the current plan details for file size limits.
- **Time:** Expect about 5–7 minutes to complete all steps.

Step 1 — Sign in and open the Claude dashboard

Open your browser, go to **claude.anthropic.com**, and click the **Log in** button. You'll see a screen with fields for your email and password; enter them and press **Enter**. After logging in, the main chat view appears – a white space with a text box at the bottom. Look for the navigation area in the sidebar; you should see a section labeled "Projects". If you don't see it immediately, look for a menu option called "Dashboard" or similar. 💬 Example: `email@example.com` + `YourPassword` → press **Enter**.
You'll know it worked when you see a list of past conversations and a side panel showing your Projects.

Step 2 — Create a new Project

In the Projects area, find a button to create a new project – it may say "+ New Project" or show a similar create option. Click it; a small dialog pops up asking for a name and an optional description. A **Project** is just a digital folder that groups together chats and files for a single aim – think of it as a binder you keep on your desk. Type a clear name (e.g., `Q3 Marketing Campaign`) and a short description (e.g., `Copy, ad ideas and feedback for the next quarter`). 💬 Example:

```
Name: Q3 Marketing Campaign
Description: All copy, ad ideas and feedback for the upcoming quarter
```

You'll know it worked when the new project appears in your project list, and the main area switches to an empty workspace titled with your project name.

Step 3 — Add existing chats to the Project

With your project open, look for a way to add existing conversations – there may be an "Add conversation" button or similar option. Click it; a panel slides in showing recent chats with check-boxes beside each title. A **chat** (or conversation) is simply a previous dialogue you've had with Claude. Tick the boxes next to the chats you want linked (e.g., "Ad copy brainstorming" and "Email subject line ideas"). After selecting, press the **Add** button at the bottom of the panel. Some versions may let you drag a chat tile into the project area instead of using check-boxes – if you don't see check-boxes, try dragging. 💬 Example: Tick "Ad copy brainstorming" and "Email subject line ideas", then click **Add**.
You'll know it worked when those chat titles appear as cards inside the project workspace, indicating they're now part of the same folder.

Step 4 — Upload supporting files

Next, locate an upload option in the project pane – it may be labeled "Attach file", "Upload file", or show as an icon. Click it; a file-chooser window opens. Navigate to a document on your computer (PDF, text file, spreadsheet or image) and select it, or simply drag the file onto the designated area. Claude will process the file, extracting its text so it can be referenced later. If you only see a large rectangle that says "Drag files here or click to upload", that's the same upload area. 💬 Example: Drag `CampaignBrief.pdf` from your desktop onto the upload box.
You'll know it worked when the file shows up as a line item inside the project, often with a tiny icon indicating its type (PDF, sheet, etc.) and a loading bar that disappears once processing finishes.

Step 5 — Write a prompt that uses everything

Now you can ask Claude to work across the whole project. In the text box at the bottom of the project screen, type a clear instruction that refers to the combined material. A **prompt** is simply the question or task you give the AI. For example, ask it to summarize the ideas from the attached chats and the PDF, then suggest three headline options. Press **Enter**. Claude will read the linked chats and the uploaded file, then start typing a response that pulls information from all sources. If the answer seems vague, try re-phrasing with more specifics – Claude usually produces better results when the prompt is detailed. 💬 Example:

```
Summarize the key ideas from all attached chats and the brief, and suggest three
headline options.
```

You'll know it worked when Claude's reply includes references to the chat content and the PDF, such as "Based on the ad copy brainstorming chat..." or "From the CampaignBrief.pdf...".

Step 6 — Share the Project (optional)

If you want teammates to see or edit the workspace, look for a **Share** button – it may be shown as an icon or found inside a "More actions" menu. Click it; a dialog appears offering a copy-able link or an email-invite field. Choose **Copy link**, then paste the URL into an email or chat message. Some versions may place the sharing options inside a dropdown menu; if you don't see the option directly, look for a menu with additional actions. 💬 Example: Click **Share**, then press **Copy link**.
You'll know it worked when a small banner appears saying "Link copied to clipboard" or when an invitation confirmation message shows up.

Wrap-up — What you've achieved and where to go next

You now have a fully functional Claude Project that brings together past chats, files, and a single prompt that pulls from everything. This workspace can be reused: simply add new chats or files as the task evolves, and ask Claude to update its output. In future sessions you can duplicate the project (look for a "Duplicate" or "Copy" option) to keep a record of each campaign or research topic. Remember that Claude can read the content you upload, but it cannot send emails or publish documents for you – you'll need to copy the generated text into your own tools.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the description:** Without a clear name or description you may forget the project's purpose.
  Fix: Add a brief description when creating the project; you can edit it later by clicking the project title.
- **Linking unrelated chats:** Adding conversations that aren't relevant can confuse Claude's responses.
  Fix: Only select chats that directly support the current goal; remove any that feel off-topic.
- **Forgetting to upload files:** If a file isn't attached, Claude can't reference its content.
  Fix: After each upload, double-check that the file appears in the project list; re-upload if the name is missing.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Planning a home renovation? Create a Project for the remodel, add design sketches, budget spreadsheets, and chat notes about contractors – then ask Claude to summarize costs and suggest next steps.

- **For your business or work:** Use a Project to collate marketing copy drafts, product spec PDFs, and internal feedback chats, allowing Claude to generate a unified campaign brief in minutes.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to set up a simple "Weekend Planning" project, add a few personal chats and a PDF itinerary, and watch Claude combine everything into a single plan.

Try it now

In the next two minutes, open Claude, create a new Project called **"My First Project"**, add one recent chat and upload a small text file, then type the prompt:

💬 Example: `Give me a quick summary of the chat and the uploaded file.`

If Claude returns a combined summary, you've successfully completed the core workflow – congratulations!

How to Build a Beginner Workout Plan With ChatGPT (and Stick to It)

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste a short description of your goal, available equipment and time into ChatGPT and get a 4-week starter plan in under a minute. The real trick is asking for a plan that updates weekly, so you stay in charge of your own progress.

If you've ever opened a fitness app, picked a "beginner" program, and then quietly abandoned it two weeks later, you're not alone. ChatGPT works well as a workout planning partner because it adjusts on demand — you tell it what hurt, what you skipped, or what time you actually have this week, and it rewrites the plan. This guide takes about six minutes to read and leaves you with a plan you can start tomorrow.

One honest note: ChatGPT can draft a sensible plan and answer general questions about exercise, but it can't see your body, your injuries, or your bloodwork. If anything hurts, stop and talk to a qualified professional. Treat the plan as a starting draft, not a medical prescription.

Before you start

- A free ChatGPT account is enough; the free plan covers text planning just fine. (Some advanced features may require a paid plan — check the current pricing page if you want extras like image or voice input.)
- A way to reach ChatGPT: the website (chatgpt.com) on a computer, or the official ChatGPT app on iOS or Android.
- About 15 minutes for your first setup, then 5 minutes each week to adjust.
- Optional but helpful: a notes app on your phone (Apple Notes, Google Keep, or any you already use) to copy the plan so it's easy to find mid-workout.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat and tell ChatGPT what you want

Open ChatGPT and start a **new chat** (look for a button labeled "New chat" or a pencil/edit icon at the top of the sidebar). A blank conversation box appears. Your first message is the most important one — it sets the goal, the time you have, and any limits you live with. ChatGPT will use these to shape every workout it suggests. 💬 Example: "I'm a complete beginner. My goal is to get stronger and have more energy. I can work out 30 minutes a day, 4 days a week. I have two dumbbells at home (about 8 kg each) and a yoga mat. I don't have any injuries. Please build me a 4-week plan I can start on Monday." You'll know it worked when ChatGPT replies with a structured plan (usually with headings like "Week 1" and days like "Day A / Day B") instead of a generic list of exercises.

Step 2 — Ask for the format that makes the plan easy to follow

Even a good plan is useless if it's a wall of text. In the same chat, ask ChatGPT to put the plan into a format you can actually read in the gym — short sessions, named exercises, and rest guidance. This is the step most beginners skip, and it's the reason they quit. 💬 Example: "Please rewrite the plan so each workout fits on one screen: a warm-up (2-3 min), 4-6 exercises with sets and reps, and a cool-down. Use plain names for the exercises and tell me how to scale each one if it's too hard or too easy." If ChatGPT replies with too much jargon ("progressive overload on compound lifts"), reply: "Use simpler words — explain any term the first time it appears." If it looks different on your device and you can't find a way to send a follow-up, look for a text box at the bottom of the screen with a small paper-plane or arrow icon — that's where replies go.

Step 3 — Save the plan somewhere you'll actually open

Don't leave the plan trapped inside ChatGPT. Open your notes app (Apple Notes, Google Keep, or whatever you already use), create a new note called "Workout — weeks 1-4," and paste the entire plan there. Now the plan is searchable, works offline, and lives next to your shopping list — which is where you actually look. 💬 Example: Copy the plan from ChatGPT, paste it into your notes app, and split it into four smaller notes named "Week 1," "Week 2," "Week 3," "Week 4." Under each, list the days as separate sub-headings. You'll know it worked when you can open the note on your phone without an internet connection and see the day's exercises within one tap.

Step 4 — Schedule a 2-minute weekly check-in

The single biggest reason plans die is that life changes — a work trip, a sore knee, a kid's school event — and the plan doesn't. Instead of abandoning the whole thing, schedule a 2-minute Sunday check-in where you ask ChatGPT to adjust the coming week. Put a repeating reminder in your phone for "Sunday 7pm — adjust workout plan." 💬 Example (send each Sunday): "Last week I did all of Week 2 except Wednesday — my lower back felt tight. This week I have 25 minutes instead of 30 on Tuesday. Please rewrite Week 3 for me." You'll know it worked when ChatGPT gives you a Week 3 that reflects what actually happened, not what was supposed to happen. That's the whole point of using an AI planner instead of a frozen PDF.

Step 5 — Keep a one-line log so the plan keeps improving

Every day after your workout, send ChatGPT one short message: what you did and how it felt. Over a month, you'll have a small log you can ask it to learn from. This is the difference between "a plan" and "your plan." 💬 Example: "Day 4 done — did all 4 exercises, squats felt easy with the dumbbells but push-ups were really hard, knees were fine." You'll know it worked when, after two or three weeks, ChatGPT starts suggesting swaps on its own ("since push-ups are

tough, let's try them on your knees this week"). That only happens if you keep feeding it small, honest notes.

Step 6 — Know when to stop and ask a human

ChatGPT is a thoughtful drafting tool, not a coach, and not a doctor. If you feel sharp or sudden pain, feel dizzy, or have a known medical condition, stop the workout and talk to a qualified professional before continuing. The plan can wait; you can't rush an injury back. 💬 Example (send if you're unsure): "I felt a sharp pull in my right shoulder during overhead press and stopped. Should I swap that exercise next time, or skip upper-body for a few days?" You'll know it worked when ChatGPT gives you a cautious, conservative answer (skip the move, try a lighter alternative, rest a few days) — and you listen.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for a "perfect" plan in one shot.** No first plan is perfect. The value of ChatGPT is the back-and-forth — start simple and adjust after week one.
- **Forgetting to mention your equipment.** If you say "give me a workout" without saying you only have dumbbells, you'll get moves that need a cable machine. Always list your gear in the first message.
- **Letting the plan live only inside ChatGPT.** If you have to log in and scroll to find it, you won't. Copy it into your notes app the same day you get it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You get a plan that fits your actual week, not a celebrity routine. When something changes — a sore ankle, a work trip — the plan bends with you in the same chat window, in plain language, in under two minutes.
- **For your business or work:** The same habit — telling the AI your real constraints and adjusting weekly — applies to almost any plan you build with AI: a study schedule, a project plan, a meal prep. The pattern is the same: state your goal, list your limits, then keep a short weekly check-in.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is right below — do it now, before you forget.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT, start a new chat, and paste this exact message: *"I'm a complete beginner. I can work out 25 minutes a day, 3 days a week, at home with no equipment. My goal is to feel stronger and less tired. Please give me a 4-week plan, formatted so each workout fits on one*

screen." Copy the reply into your notes app. You'll have a real plan in your hand before you stand up from your desk.

Add helpful comments to your code with GitHub Copilot – beginner guide

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll be able to ask **GitHub Copilot** to write easy-to-read comments above any line of code, even if you've never opened a code editor before. This tutorial is for absolute beginners who want to make their scripts clearer for themselves and anyone else who reads them.

Before you start

- A free GitHub account (you'll sign in to VS Code with it).
- Visual Studio Code installed on your computer (Windows, macOS or Linux).
- GitHub Copilot enabled — the free tier for individual developers works, or you can upgrade to a paid plan for more usage.
- A simple code or text file you're happy to experiment with.
- About 10 minutes of uninterrupted time.

Step 1 — Download and install Visual Studio Code

Visit **code.visualstudio.com** in any web browser; you'll see a large button that usually says "Download for Windows", "Download for macOS" or "Download for Linux". Click that button, then open the installer that lands in your Downloads folder (it ends with *.exe*, *.dmg*, *.deb* or *.rpm*). The installer walks you through a few screens – just click "Next", accept the license, and press "Install". When the installer finishes, it launches VS Code, showing a window with a thin left sidebar and a blank center editor. If the button doesn't match exactly, look for a link that says "Other platforms" or "Get VS Code for ...". **You'll know it worked when the VS Code icon appears on your desktop or in your applications folder and the program opens to an empty editor.**

Step 2 — Sign in to GitHub from inside VS Code

With VS Code open, glance at the bottom-left corner; you should see a small silhouette icon – this is the **Accounts** button (think of it as the door that lets VS Code meet your online identity). Click it; a tiny panel slides up offering "Sign in with GitHub". Choose that option; your default web browser opens and asks you to confirm the sign-in. After you approve, the panel disappears and a little avatar or your initials replace the silhouette. If you don't see the silhouette, open the menu bar, select **View** → **Command Palette**, type "Sign in" and pick the option that mentions GitHub. **You'll know it worked when your GitHub username or avatar shows up in the bottom-left corner of VS Code.**

Step 3 — Install the GitHub Copilot extension

In the left sidebar look for an icon that looks like four squares arranged in a grid – this opens the **Extensions** view (imagine a mini app store built into VS Code). Click the icon; a panel appears with a search bar at the top. Type **GitHub Copilot** into that bar. The first result is the official Copilot extension with an **Install** button next to it. Click **Install**; VS Code downloads the extension and automatically enables it. Once the process finishes, a new Copilot logo (usually a stylised chat bubble) appears in the activity bar – the thin vertical strip on the far left. If you don't see the four-square icon, you can also open **View** → **Extensions** from the top menu. **You'll know it worked when the Extensions list shows GitHub Copilot as "Enabled" and the Copilot icon appears in the activity bar.**

Step 4 — Open a code file in the editor

Click the first icon in the left sidebar – it looks like two stacked pages and represents the **Explorer** (think of it as a folder browser). In the Explorer pane navigate to a folder that contains a file such as `example.js` or `notes.txt`. Single-click the file to select it, then double-click to open it; the file's contents fill the central editor area and a column of line numbers appears on the left. (A **function** is just a named bundle of instructions, like a recipe card, and a **comment** is a note for human readers that the computer silently ignores.) If the Explorer isn't visible, press `Ctrl+Shift+E` (on macOS, `Cmd+Shift+E`). **You'll know it worked when the file's text appears in the editor with line numbers running down the left side.**

Step 5 — Ask GitHub Copilot to suggest a comment above a line of code

Place the cursor on an empty line directly above the line you want explained. Type `//` followed by a short instruction such as `Explain what this line does`. In many cases, GitHub Copilot will show a faint, gray **ghost text** suggestion right after you finish typing – this is Copilot's inline auto-complete behavior. If the ghost text appears, press **Tab** to turn it into a real comment; press **Escape** if you want to discard it and try a different prompt.

If no ghost text shows up, it may be because the instruction is too short or the extension needs a moment to load. In that case you can use the built-in command as a fallback: open the Command Palette (`Ctrl+Shift+P` / `Cmd+Shift+P`) and run **"GitHub Copilot: Explain"** (the exact command name may vary slightly). Copilot will then insert a comment based on the line you have selected.

You'll know it worked when a readable comment appears above the target line, summarizing its purpose in plain English.

Step 6 — Review, edit and save the suggestion

Read the newly inserted comment aloud; if it accurately describes the code, you're finished. If the wording is off, simply click into the comment line and type a correction – Copilot does not learn from these edits, so manual tweaks are normal. To finish, save the file by pressing `Ctrl+S` (or `Cmd+S` on macOS); the dot next to the file name in the tab disappears, indicating the file is saved. If you notice the comment is still unclear, return to Step 5 and re-phrase your prompt (for example, `Summarize the tax-calculation step in plain English`).

Common mistakes

- **Typing a whole code block instead of a short prompt.** GitHub Copilot works best with brief instructions like `// Explain this step`. Fix: keep the trigger line under 10 words.
- **Pressing Escape before accepting the ghost text.** The gray suggestion is the output you want; pressing Escape discards it. Fix: press **Tab** to accept the suggestion, then edit if needed.
- **Expecting Copilot to understand very complex logic on the first try.** Long or ambiguous code often yields vague comments. Fix: add more context to your prompt or break the code into smaller chunks and ask for one comment at a time.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly add self-explanatory notes to personal scripts you copy-paste, so the next time you open the file you remember what each line does.
- **For your business or work:** Teams can use Copilot-generated comments to make handovers smoother, because the code becomes easier to read for anyone joining the project – without needing a separate documentation sprint.
- **If you're just getting started:** Open a tiny file you already own, place the cursor on a new line, type `// Explain what this line does`, and watch GitHub Copilot turn it into a friendly comment in seconds.

Try it now

Open any small code or text file you have, put the cursor on a blank line above a line you recognize, type `// Explain what this line does`, press **Tab** when the ghost text appears (or use the "GitHub Copilot: Explain" command if it doesn't), and then save the file. In under two minutes you'll see your first Copilot-written comment right in the editor.